Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Scrambling, Specificity Effects, and Phasal Variation in Turkish and Uyghur

Robin Jenkins

This article develops a new approach to specificity effects based on comparing differential object marking (DOM) in Turkish with a novel DOM paradigm observed in Uyghur. On this basis, I argue that specificity does not always correlate with VP-externality (e.g., Diesing 1992); rather, it correlates with whether the object has moved to a particular structural position. Further, I show that the variation observed between the two DOM paradigms can be captured as a result of a difference in the languages' middle-field phase boundaries. Several additional contrasts between the two languages are traced back to this difference in phase boundaries, which is also situated within a broader pattern of typological variation.

Keywords: differential object marking, specificity, phases, successive-cyclic movement

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

1 Introduction

Many languages display a pattern where there is a correlation between an object's interpretation and its structural height. In the typical case, objects that are interpreted as specific/definite must move from a VP-internal position to a position outside of the VP. Under standard analyses of this effect, if an object moves for this reason, further movement operations will not affect the object's interpretation. Hence, what standard analyses aim to capture is that objects that reside in a position outside of the VP must be interpreted as specific/definite (1).

(1) a. . . . [$_{VP}$ V $DP_{[-SPECIFIC]}$]
b. . . . [$_{FP}$ $DP_{[+SPECIFIC]}$ F [$_{VP}$ V ~~DP~~]]

I argue that this is not the right approach and that simple VP-externality is not a reliable guide to whether an object receives a specific/definite interpretation, even in languages where there is a correlation between syntactic height of the object and specific/definite interpretation. To show that derivational height and interpretation do not always correlate, I compare the differential object marking (DOM) patterns of two closely related languages: Turkish and Uyghur. Like many languages, both instantiate a DOM system where objects that are high in specificity are marked

I'm very grateful to my Turkish, Uyghur, and Japanese language speakers, with special thanks to Subhi Ershidin, Subhi Tarim, and Shaida David for Uyghur. Thanks to Željko Bošković, Vicki Carstens, Laura Kalin, Travis Major, Mamoru Saito, Adrian Stegovec, and audiences at CLS 57, TU+6, and UConn LingLunch for discussion and feedback on various aspects of this article. Thanks as well to two anonymous *LI* reviewers, who greatly improved the article. Finally, thank you to Željko, Mamoru, and Adrian for reading and commenting on several iterations of this article.

© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

with accusative. Thus, in the general case, objects with a specific interpretation have a morphological reflex. Although the two languages' DOM patterns are highly similar in many respects, Uyghur's pattern has one novel property that distinguishes it from Turkish regarding the correlation between syntactic height and specificity. For Turkish (as for many languages), when an object surfaces in a VP-external position it must receive a specific interpretation. I show that in Uyghur, this is not always the case; that is, the correlation between syntactic height with respect to the VP and interpretation breaks down systematically in a well-defined case.

In light of this contrast between Turkish and Uyghur, I will argue that specificity-related DOM effects are not strictly correlated with the object's VP-externality, as previous analyses have claimed. Instead, I offer an alternative picture that does not assume such a correlation always holds. I will argue that the specificity effects observed in Turkish and Uyghur depend on whether DOM objects move to a *particular*, VP-external position in the structure. Hence, I will argue that in the general case it is not the object's height relative to the VP that correlates with specificity; rather, it is whether the object is located in a particular structural position. I show that an analysis that captures this effect (rather than relying simply on VP-externality) predicts both the Turkish and Uyghur DOM patterns.

The article is structured as follows. In sections 2.1–2.2, I present an outline of the Turkish and Uyghur DOM systems. In section 2.3, I present the novel contrast between Turkish and Uyghur. Specifically, while marked objects in Turkish must always receive a specific interpretation regardless of the object's position in the clause, the situation in Uyghur is different. In some positions in the clause, marked objects can only receive a specific interpretation, but in other positions, this specific interpretation is no longer forced. In section 3, I consider existing analyses of DOM and show that the standard approach cannot capture both the Turkish and Uyghur DOM patterns. I also present an alternative analysis: I argue that the specificity effect observed in Turkish's and Uyghur's DOM is due to whether or not the object DP has moved to a particular position. Further, I argue that the contrast observed here between Turkish and Uyghur is due to a difference in phasal boundaries that affects the movement paths available to object DPs in these languages. In section 4, I provide additional evidence for this difference in phasal boundaries between Turkish and Uyghur by examining three other contrasts between the two languages that can be traced back to this difference. In section 5, I situate the phasal variation observed between Turkish and Uyghur within a larger pattern of typological variation through a parallelism with another phenomenon, namely, agreement. In section 6, I conclude.

2 DOM in Turkish and Uyghur

In this section, I outline the DOM patterns of Turkish and Uyghur. I highlight that in both languages, objects that surface with DOM morphology are higher in the structure than bare objects. I show that while Turkish and Uyghur pattern quite similarly with respect to their DOM systems, they diverge in an important way. Specifically, I show that while in Turkish all objects that have evacuated the VP must surface with DOM morphology *and* uniformly have a specific interpretation, this is not the case in Uyghur. For Uyghur, while DOM objects have an obligatorily specific interpretation when clause-medial, this is not the case when they move to a higher position.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2.1 DOM and Specificity

Turkish and Uyghur instantiate a typologically common DOM system where specific direct objects must surface with dedicated morphology. In both languages, specific objects surface with accusative case while nonspecific objects lack it.

Shown below is the Turkish pattern, where the unmarked object is nonspecific ((2a), (3a)) and the object marked with accusative (*-(y)**I***) must be interpreted as specific ((2b), (3b)) (see, e.g., Erguvanlı 1984, Dede 1986, Enç 1991, Diesing 1992, Kornfilt 1997, Öztürk 2005).[1]

(2) a. Ali kitap oku-du.
Ali book read-PST.3SG
'Ali read a book/books.'
b. Ali kitab-**ı** oku-du.
Ali book-ACC read-PST.3SG
'Ali read the book.'

(3) a. (Ben) doktor arı-yor-um.
1SG doctor look.for-PROG-1SG
'I am looking for a doctor/doctors.'
b. (Ben) doktor-**u** arı-yor-um.
1SG doctor-ACC look.for-PROG-1SG
'I am looking for the doctor.'

The same pattern is observed for Uyghur (Tömür 2003, Asarina 2011, Major 2021). Objects that are nonspecific lack accusative case ((4a), (5a)), while specific objects are marked with accusative (*-ni*) ((4b), (5b)).

(4) a. Mehmet mashin xala-y-du.
Mehmet car want-NPST-3SG
'Mehmet wants a car/cars.'
b. Mehmet mashina-**ni** xala-y-du.
Mehmet car-ACC want-NPST-3SG
'Mehmet wants the car.'

(5) a. (Men) doktor izde-wat-i-men.
1SG doctor look.for-PROG-NPST-1SG
'I am looking for a doctor/doctors.'
b. (Men) doktor-**ni** izde-wat-i-men.
1SG doctor-ACC look.for-PROG-NPST-1SG
'I am looking for the doctor.'

[1] Unless cited from another source, all Turkish and Uyghur data were elicited from native speakers by the author.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2.2 *Height of Marked and Unmarked Objects*

Previous works have observed for a number of DOM languages that marked objects are structurally higher than unmarked objects.[2] This has long been observed to be the case for Turkish, where accusative objects occupy a VP-external position, whereas unmarked objects remain VP-internal (e.g., Diesing 1992, Kennelly 1994, Zidani-Eroğlu 1997b, Kelepir 2001, Öztürk 2005, Kornfilt 2020). This difference in height between marked and unmarked objects holds in Uyghur as well (Major 2021).

As (6) shows, in Turkish marked objects must precede manner adverbs such as *hızlı* 'quickly', while unmarked objects must follow them.

(6) a. Ali (*hızlı) kitab-**ı** (hızlı) oku-du.
Ali (quickly) book-ACC (quickly) read-PST.3SG
'Ali read the book quickly.'
b. Ali (hızlı) kitap (*hızlı) oku-du.
Ali (quickly) book (quickly) read-PST.3SG
'Ali read a book/books quickly.'

In Uyghur, the same facts obtain. Accusative objects must precede the manner adverb (7a) and bare objects must follow it (7b).

(7) a. Mehmet (*tëz) kitab-**ni** (tëz) oqu-di.
Mehmet (quickly) book-ACC (quickly) read-PST.3SG
'Mehmet read the book quickly.'
b. Mehmet (tëz) kitap (*tëz) oqu-di.
Mehmet (quickly) book (quickly) read-PST.3SG
'Mehmet read a book/books quickly.'

Assuming that manner adverbs adjoin to the VP, accusative DPs in Turkish and Uyghur must be higher in the clause (i.e., VP-external) than unmarked DPs, which remain in their base, VP-internal position.

Further evidence comes from the default order of internal arguments in ditransitives. In both languages, the default order of direct object (DO) and indirect object (IO) depends on whether the DO bears accusative. In Turkish, if the DO bears accusative, then the default order is DO>IO (8a). But if the DO is unmarked, then the default order is reversed: IO>DO (8b).

(8) a. Ali kitab-**ı** Hasan-a ver-di.
Ali book-ACC Hasan-DAT give-PST.3SG
'Ali gave the book to Hasan.'
(Kornfilt 2003:140, confirmed by an anonymous reviewer)

[2] This is not universal with respect to DOM; see Kalin and Weisser 2019.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

b. Ali Hasan-a kitap ver-di.
Ali Hasan-DAT book give-PST.3SG
'Ali gave a book/books to Hasan.'
(example from an anonymous reviewer)

For Uyghur, the same alternation occurs. Marked DOs display the DO>IO order (9a); unmarked DOs display the IO>DO order (9b).

(9) a. Mehmet xet-**ni** Aliyë-gë yaz-i-du.
Mehmet letter-ACC Aliyë-DAT write-NPST-3SG
'Mehmet will write the letter to Aliyë.'
b. Mehmet Aliyë-gë xet yaz-i-du.
Mehmet Aliyë-DAT letter write-NPST-3SG
'Mehmet will write a letter/letters to Aliyë.'

Assuming that in both Turkish and Uyghur, IOs are generated at least as high as Spec,VP, those alternations further indicate that accusative objects are higher in the structure than unmarked objects, presumably in a position above Spec,VP.[3]

Another argument that accusative objects are higher in the structure than unmarked objects comes from scope possibilities relative to negation. In Turkish, unmarked objects must scope under negation; a wide scope reading is impossible (10a). Conversely, DOs marked with accusative most naturally receive a wide scope interpretation and (without special context) resist a narrow scope interpretation (10b) (Kelepir 2001).

(10) a. Ali kitap oku-ma-dı.
Ali book read-NEG-3SG
'Ali didn't read any book/books.' (NEG>*book*, **book*>NEG)
b. Ali kitab-**ı** oku-ma-dı.
Ali book-ACC read-NEG-PST.3SG
'Ali didn't read the book.' (*book*>NEG, ?NEG>*book*)

The same facts are observed in Uyghur. Bare objects must take narrow scope relative to negation (11a); accusative objects can scope outside of negation (11b).

(11) a. Mehmet kitap oqu-ma-di.
Mehmet book read-NEG-PST.3SG
'Mehmet didn't read any book/books.' (NEG>*book*, **book*>NEG)
b. Mehmet kitab-**ni** oqu-ma-di.
Mehmet book-ACC read-NEG-PST.3SG
'Mehmet didn't read the book.' (*book*>NEG, ?NEG>*book*)

[3] Alternatively, IOs could be generated in an ApplP above VP. In either case, the above point would remain.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Assuming that scopal relations reflect a c-command relation between the object DP and Neg, where the DP must c-command Neg to take wide scope, and assuming that Neg is merged above VP, the scope facts for both Uyghur and Turkish further indicate that accusative objects are higher in the structure than their unmarked counterparts.

To summarize, both Turkish and Uyghur instantiate a DOM pattern where objects marked with accusative receive a specific interpretation while unmarked objects do not. Further, DOM objects in both languages are structurally higher than their unmarked counterparts.

2.3 DOM and Scrambling

Turkish and Uyghur allow for a relatively free ordering of nominals in the clause (for Turkish, see e.g. Erguvanlı 1984, Kornfilt 1997, 2003, von Heusinger and Kornfilt 2005, Şener 2010; and for Uyghur, see e.g. Hahn 2015, Major 2021). In Turkish, the object can be dislocated from its clause-medial position and scrambled over the subject, as in (12). When scrambled, the object must be marked accusative and receives a specific interpretation in this position (Erguvanlı 1984, von Heusinger and Kornfilt 2005).

(12) Doktor$_i$-**u** ben t_i arı-yor-um.
doctor-ACC 1SG look.for-PROG-1SG
'I am looking for the doctor.'

The pattern in (12), where dislocated objects must surface with DOM morphology and have their canonical DOM interpretation, is commonly attested crosslinguistically. In Spanish, human objects like the one in (13a) that surface with the dative preposition *a* must receive a specific interpretation (e.g., Torrego 1998, Rodríguez-Mondoñedo 2007, López 2012).[4] This also holds when the DP moves to the left periphery (13b) (e.g., Laca 1987, Leonetti 2004).

(13) a. Habían incluido **a** dos catedráticos en la lista.
included.PLUP.3PL DOM two professors in the list
'They included two professors in the list.'
b. **A** dos catedráticos, los habían incluido en la lista.
DOM two professors CL.3PL included.PLUP.3PL in the list
'Two professors, they included in the list.'
(Leonetti 2004:86; glosses mine)

The fact that Turkish (and Spanish) show this kind of uniformity in interpretation regarding dislocated objects seems unsurprising. Intuitively, if a nominal has a certain interpretation in one position (i.e., specific), then movement to an even higher position should not affect its interpretation.

[4] Torrego (1998) also shows that like accusative-marked objects in Turkish and Uyghur, *a*-marked objects in Spanish are higher in the structure (i.e., VP-external) than unmarked objects.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Surprisingly, Uyghur departs from this common pattern. In Uyghur, as in Turkish, objects that have been fronted to clause-initial position must be marked with accusative. Unlike in Turkish, though, fronted objects lose their obligatory specific interpretation, as in (14).[5]

(14) Doktor$_i$-**ni** men t_i izde-wat-i-men.
doctor-ACC 1SG look.for-PROG-NPST-1SG
'I am looking for the doctor/a doctor.'

Interestingly, the same contrast between Turkish and Uyghur that is found with specificity effects occurs with object *wh*-phrases regarding the notion of d(iscourse)-linking, which is often related to notions like topicality, specificity, and definiteness (Comorovski 1996, Boeckx and Grohmann 2004, Jaeger 2004; in fact, Grohmann (2006) places fronted d-linked *wh*-phrases in Spec,TopP). In Turkish, in-situ *wh*-objects can be optionally marked with accusative, as in (15). When the *wh*-phrase is marked with accusative, it must receive a d-linked interpretation. Further, when the *wh*-phrase is fronted, as in (16), it must be accusative and receives a d-linked interpretation (Şener 2010).

(15) a. Ali ne gör-dü?
Ali what see-PST.3SG
'What did Ali see?'
b. Ali ne-**yi** gör-dü?
Ali what-ACC see-PST.3SG
'What among these things did Ali see?'

(16) Ne$_i$-*(**yi**) Ali t_i gör-dü?
what-ACC Ali see-PST.3SG
'What among these things did Ali see?'

Uyghur patterns with Turkish regarding in-situ *wh*-phrases. As shown in (17), the *wh*-object can be optionally marked with accusative; when so marked, it must receive a d-linked interpretation.

[5] The loss of an obligatory specific interpretation when the accusative-marked direct object is dislocated to clause-initial position is especially stark with arguments of verbs of creation such as *build* and *give birth.* As shown in (i), accusative objects generally resist being arguments of verbs of creation due to the existence presupposition that marked objects generally carry (see Kelepir 2001 for discussion of this effect in Turkish). But as shown in (ii), in Uyghur scrambling the marked object ameliorates the infelicity felt when the marked object is clause-medial because—in its new, clause-initial position—it no longer requires a specific interpretation.

(i) #Adil mashina-**ni** yasa-wat-i-du.
Adil car-ACC build-PROG-NPST-3SG
'Adil is building the car.'

(ii) Mashina$_i$-**ni** Adil t_i yasa-wat-i-du.
car-ACC Adil build-PROG-NPST-3SG
'Adil is building a car/cars.'

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Importantly, unlike in Turkish, when the *wh*-phrase is fronted, while it must be accusative the d-linked interpretation is not forced (18).

(17) a. Mehmet neme ye-di?
Mehmet what eat-PST.3SG
'What did Mehmet eat?'
b. Mehmet neme-**ni** ye-di?
Mehmet what-ACC eat-PST.3SG
'What among these things did Mehmet eat?'

(18) Neme$_i$-*(**ni**) Mehmet t_i ye-di?
what-ACC Mehmet eat-PST.3SG
'What (among these things) did Mehmet eat?'

This is the same kind of contrast between Turkish and Uyghur as the one observed regarding (12) and (14).[6]

The pattern Uyghur instantiates is highly unexpected. In Uyghur, the interpretation of DOM objects appears to be conditioned by whether or not the object is the target of further movement operations. As in Turkish, when the object is bare, it cannot move from its verb-adjacent position, and cannot be interpreted as specific ((3a), (5a)). When Uyghur direct objects are marked, they must appear higher in the structure than their unmarked counterparts. Unlike in Turkish, however, their interpretation in this case is not uniform. When objects are located in a clause-medial VP-external position, they must be interpreted as specific (5b); when they move to a higher position, they lose this obligatory specific interpretation (14).

In this respect, Uyghur's DOM pattern differs sharply from that of Turkish. In particular, the two differ regarding whether or not further movement can have an effect on the object's interpretation. In Turkish, DOM objects receive the same interpretation whether or not they have undergone additional movement—that is, whether or not they have been fronted clause-initially. In Uyghur, this is not the case. When the DOM object is located in a clause-medial VP-external position, it must be interpreted as specific, but when it undergoes further movement, it loses this obligatory interpretation.

3 Analysis

The previous section outlined the DOM patterns instantiated in Turkish and Uyghur. In Turkish, marked object DPs move to a clause-medial VP-external position and are interpreted as specific. When object DPs move from this position to an even higher one, the object maintains this specific

[6] As pointed out in footnote 9, the pattern observed in Uyghur (17)–(18) closely parallels the pattern found with Icelandic *wh*-objects under object shift, which is also related to notions like specificity and definiteness.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

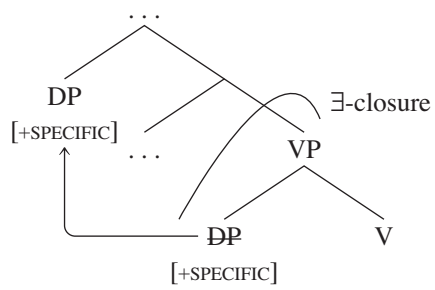
interpretation. In Uyghur, marked objects must also move to a clause-medial VP-external position and must receive a specific interpretation in this position. But when object DPs move from this position to an even higher one, a specific interpretation is no longer forced. In section 3.1, I show that existing approaches to DOM fail to capture the Uyghur pattern. In section 3.2, I present a new analysis that captures both the Uyghur and the Turkish patterns.

3.1 Existing Analyses

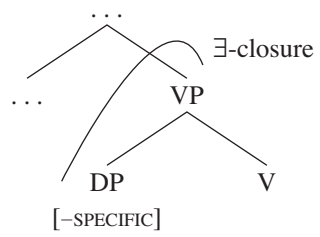
On a number of approaches, specificity-related DOM has been understood in terms of a [+SPECIFIC] feature triggering movement of the DP outside of the VP to a higher position (e.g., Diesing 1992, Diesing and Jelinek 1995, Bhatt and Anagnostopoulou 1996, Kelepir 2001). The essential idea here is that the split between DOM and non-DOM objects is due to the presence or absence of [+SPECIFIC] on the DP, which correlates with whether or not the DP must raise outside of the VP.

One standard implementation of these approaches is to posit an LF interpretation rule that requires [+SPECIFIC] DPs to raise outside of the VP (Diesing 1992, 1996, Diesing and Jelinek 1995, Bhatt and Anagnostopoulou 1996). Here, DPs that are VP-internal are subject to an existential closure operation at LF; thus, DPs that have [+SPECIFIC] must raise to avoid being bound by an existential quantifier, which would cause an LF interpretation crash (as in (19)). Conversely, DPs that are [−SPECIFIC] must remain VP-internal in order to be existentially bound (as in (20)).

(19)



(20)



Further, on such approaches the presence of overt case morphology on the raised DPs can be taken to be a reflex of Case licensing from a higher head, such as v (where such licensing crucially requires movement; see below), or a reflex of the DP being in a local enough relationship with a higher DP as in a dependent case approach (Marantz 1991, Baker and Vinokurova 2010, Baker 2015).

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

More generally, on such approaches, where DPs that have [+SPECIFIC] must raise outside the VP and DPs that lack this feature must remain VP-internal, the following effect is predicted to hold for object DPs:[7]

(21) If the object DP c-commands VP, then the DP is [+SPECIFIC].

This indeed holds for Turkish. As shown above, Turkish accusative objects must receive a specific interpretation regardless of their surface position, whether clause-medial (2b) or clause-initial (12).

(2) b. Ali kitab-**ı** oku-du.
Ali book-ACC read-PST.3SG
'Ali read the book.'

(12) Doktor$_i$-**u** ben t_i arı-yor-um.
doctor-ACC 1SG look.for-PROG-1SG
'I am looking for the doctor.'

This type of account predicts the Turkish pattern in a straightforward fashion. Since DPs that have [+SPECIFIC] must raise outside the VP to avoid an LF interpretation crash (and thus are accessible for receiving ACC-Case, which is assumed to require movement) and DPs that have [−SPECIFIC] must remain VP-internal in order to be existentially bound (and are inaccessible for receiving ACC-Case), only DPs that receive a specific interpretation and surface with accusative case can appear outside of the V-adjacent position. Thus, an analysis that has (21) as its effect predicts Turkish's DOM pattern since here the DOM object's interpretation and morphology correlate with its structural height.

The Uyghur facts, however, are not predicted to be possible on such an analysis. In fact, the Uyghur DOM pattern regarding dislocated objects presents a clear exception to the predicted effect described in (21). As illustrated earlier in (4b), Uyghur clause-medial DOM objects obligatorily receive a specific interpretation.

(4) b. Mehmet mashina-**ni** xala-y-du.
Mehmet car-ACC want-NPST-3SG
'Mehmet wants the car.'

However, as we saw in (14), when the object is dislocated to a clause-initial position, a specific interpretation is no longer forced.

[7] An alternative approach to specificity-based DOM, which also has (21) as its effect, is to directly tie the presence of the feature [+SPECIFIC] to the presence of the feature [*u*Case] (e.g., Torrego 1998, Rodríguez-Mondoñedo 2007, Ormazabal and Romero 2013a). On this approach, movement outside of the VP is forced by the DP's Case-licensing needs (which, in turn, correlate with bearing [+SPECIFIC]). Since only [+SPECIFIC] DPs require Case licensing, only [+SPECIFIC] DPs are predicted to raise outside the VP, thus deriving the effect in (21). For an alternative approach regarding the relationship between DOM morphology and licensing of the object DP, see López 2012.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

(14) Doktor$_i$-**ni** men t_i izde-wat-i-men.
doctor-ACC 1SG look.for-PROG-NPST-1SG
'I am looking for a/the doctor.'

The loss of an obligatory specific interpretation upon further movement to the clause-initial position, as in (14), is not predicted on an analysis where specificity correlates with VP-externality. Here, nonspecific objects must remain VP-internal in order to be bound by existential closure and be interpretable at LF; see (20). Thus, on this analysis, only DPs that are specific raise outside of the VP, a specific interpretation being enforced by this movement. The nonspecific interpretation available for the DP in (14) is thus predicted to be impossible.

To summarize, the crucial point of failure for this type of analysis is that whether an object has or lacks an obligatory specific interpretation is correlated with the relative height of the object with respect to VP—more precisely, with whether the object DP is VP-external or not. On this type of account, where relative height correlates with specificity, if a DP is VP-external, then the only possible derivation is the one where the DP bears the feature [+SPECIFIC]. Whether that DP has undergone further movement to an even higher, clause-initial position is irrelevant. What the Uyghur data show is that it is not relative height with respect to the VP that correlates with specificity. From a theoretical standpoint, this means that any account that analyzes specificity effects in terms of relative derivational height with respect to VP will not be able to capture Uyghur's DOM pattern.

3.2 New Analysis

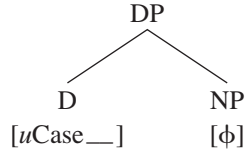
The previous section showed that Uyghur's DOM pattern does not obey (21), which means that any analysis that forces VP-external object DPs to receive a specific interpretation cannot account for this pattern. In light of this problem, I propose a new analysis that does not make a connection between VP-externality and whether or not DP bears the feature [+SPECIFIC]. Instead, I will argue that the correct analysis of the Turkish and Uyghur DOM patterns is the one with this effect:

(22) If DP moves to Spec,vP, then DP is [+SPECIFIC].

As previously shown, an analysis with (21) as its effect, while able to capture the Turkish pattern, cannot capture the Uyghur pattern. I will argue that an analysis with (22) as its effect can capture both patterns. The key to the correlation between specificity and derivational height is not VP-externality of the object DP but whether or not the DP has moved to a particular position at any point over the course of the derivation.

To implement this for Turkish and Uyghur, I adopt the proposal argued for in Massam 2001 and Danon 2006, among other works, that nominals can enter the structure as either DPs or NPs.

(23)



Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

(24) NP
|
N
[ϕ]

If the nominal projects a DP, as in (23), then it carries a [*u*Case] feature that must be licensed by a higher head, such as v. Conversely, if the nominal does not project a DP and merges as an NP, as in (24), then a [*u*Case] feature is not present and the nominal does not require licensing from a higher head.[8]

With respect to objects that do not surface with case morphology, I adopt the standard assumption that they merge as NPs, as in (24), and pseudo-incorporate with V. Previous works have observed that Turkish's caseless objects display the hallmarks of pseudo-incorporation (e.g., Kornfilt 2003, Öztürk 2005). In particular, Turkish's caseless objects are immobile and must remain V-adjacent (25) and also receive a "number-neutral" interpretation (26).

(25) (*Kitap) Ali (*kitap) dün kitap oku-du.
(book) Ali (book) yesterday book read-PST.3SG
'Ali read a book/books yesterday.'

(26) Adam oğlan-a taş at-tı.
man boy-DAT stone throw-PST.3SG
'The man threw a stone/stones at the boy.'

As (27)–(28) show, the same facts are observed with Uyghur's bare objects.

(27) (*Xet) Mehmet (*xet) ete xet yez-i-du.
(letter) Mehmet (letter) tomorrow letter write-NPST-3SG
'Mehmet will write a letter/letters tomorrow.'

(28) Adem oghl-ga tash tashla-di.
man boy-DAT stone throw-PST.3SG
'The man threw a stone/stones at the boy.'

Given that Uyghur's bare objects pattern identically with those of Turkish in this respect, it appears that Uyghur also allows for pseudo-incorporation. Here, I simply assume the standard approach to pseudo-incorporation (e.g., Massam 2001, Sağ 2019); more precisely, pseudo-incorporated objects are generated as NPs and thus do not require Case licensing, remain VP-internal, and (due to LF requirements) cannot carry the feature [+SPECIFIC].

[8] As an anonymous reviewer notes, this difference between Turkish/Uyghur DOM and unmarked objects, where the former requires Case but the latter do not, parallels Spanish DOM patterns. For Spanish, Ormazabal and Romero (2013b) argue that the relevant difference between DOM and unmarked objects is that the former require Case but the latter do not. One important difference between the Spanish and Turkish/Uyghur cases, however, is that while in Turkish/Uyghur the presence of [*u*Case] (and, thus, DOM) correlates with the projection of a DP layer (and the lack of [*u*Case] with the absence of a DP layer), in Spanish both DOM and unmarked objects seem to project a DP layer (Ormazabal and Romero 2013b). Thus, as the anonymous reviewer suggests, the relevant difference between Spanish and Turkish/Uyghur may be whether D obligatorily bears [*u*Case] (as in Turkish/Uyghur) or not (as in Spanish).

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

The second element of the present analysis concerns the effect described in (22). As shown in section 3.1, an analysis that assumes that a DP's height relative to the VP is the key to understanding the specificity effects cannot account for the full range of relevant facts. Instead, I propose that the relevant condition for determining whether the object DP must be interpreted as specific is whether it has moved to a *particular* structural position, as stated in (22), repeated here.

(22) If DP moves to Spec,vP, then DP is [+SPECIFIC].

Thus, on the present proposal it is not relative height but a specific structural position of the object DP that determines whether a specific interpretation is forced. The analysis is neutral as to what underlying mechanism imposes this restriction on DPs moving to Spec,vP. However, it should be noted that previous work has given compelling evidence that functional heads such as v can impose semantically based restrictions concerning which DPs can merge to their specifier. Thus, Wiltschko and Ritter (2015) and Adger and Harbour (2007) argue that in Blackfoot and Kiowa, respectively, only DPs that bear the feature [+ANIMATE] can merge in Spec,vP. From this perspective, (22) can be regarded as a restriction of the same kind but affecting DPs with the feature [+SPECIFIC] instead (see also Browne 1970, Berent 1980, and Rudin 1997 on the relationship between animacy and specificity).[9] At any rate, the crucial point is that it is movement of

[9] An interesting question arises as to why the Spec,vP position correlates with specificity for DPs located there. As an anonymous reviewer suggests, a way to approach the issue may be to treat specificity as an LF effect that emerges due to vP's predicate status (rather than a property encoded as a syntactically active feature). I agree that this restriction on Spec,vP may, in fact, be an LF effect that is connected to vP's predicate status (see also the following paragraph). There may even be a connection with Quantifier Raising (QR), which also has been argued to target the edge of vP due to vP's predicate status.

Another possibility is that it is the position itself, Spec,vP, that imposes a specific interpretation on the DP (rather than only DPs with the feature [+SPECIFIC] being able to move to Spec,vP). In other words (and this is what is important for present purposes), it is by occupying a particular position that specificity effects are induced. Such an effect can also be observed with Icelandic *wh*-objects under object shift. In Icelandic multiple *wh*-questions, the *wh*-object can surface either in its base, VP-internal position (ia) or VP-externally in the object shift position (ib), as indicated by the position of the *wh*-phrase with respect to negation. Interestingly, when the *wh*-object surfaces in the object shift position (as in (ib)), it must receive a d-linked interpretation (see Diesing 1996 for discussion of the semantic effects of object shift). Further, under regular *wh*-object movement to Spec,CP, as in (ii), a d-linked interpretation is not forced. (Examples are from Gísli Rúnar Harðarson, pers. comm.)

(i) a. Hver les ekki hvað?
who reads not what
'Who doesn't read what?'
b. Hver les hvað ekki?
who reads what not
'Who doesn't read what (among these books)?'

(ii) Hvað las Maria?
what read Maria
'What did Maria read?'

What these facts indicate is that whether or not a d-linked interpretation is forced is a reflex of whether or not the DP moves to the object shift position in the derivation. If the DP does not move, as in (ia) and (ii), then a d-linked interpretation is not forced. But if the DP does move to this position, as in (ib), then a d-linked interpretation is forced. In this respect, Icelandic and Uyghur are parallels. This parallelism is even more obvious with Uyghur's *wh*-objects (as discussed in section 2.3); Uyghur's accusative-marked *wh*-phrases must be interpreted as d-linked in clause-medial position, but when fronted further, they lose this interpretation. This parallelism may suggest that Uyghur's accusative objects derive their specific/d-linked interpretations through movement to a particular position, as is standardly assumed for Icelandic.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

the object DP to a particular position, Spec,vP (not simply movement of the object DP outside of VP), that correlates with a specific interpretation.[10]

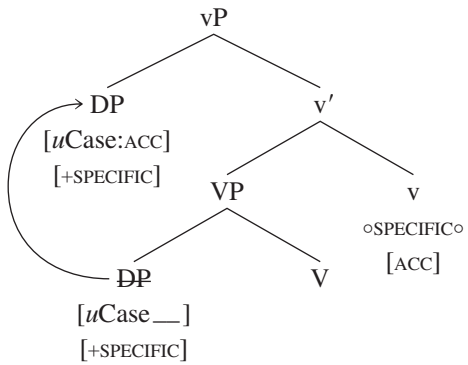
Now consider the Turkish sentence (2b) and the Uyghur sentence (4b) once again. In both, the objects surface in a clause-medial position with accusative marking and must be specific.

(2) b. Ali kitab-**ı** oku-du.
Ali book-ACC read-PST.3SG
'Ali read the book.'

(4) b. Mehmet mashina-**ni** xala-y-du.
Mehmet car-ACC want-NPST-3SG
'Mehmet wants the car.'

On the present analysis, (2b) and (4b) are analyzed as in (29). The object is generated inside the VP as a DP with a [*u*Case] feature, which requires licensing from a higher head, that is, v. Here, the DP moves to Spec,vP and receives ACC-Case. While in principle the DP can either have or lack the feature [+SPECIFIC], in the latter case the derivation where the DP moves to Spec,vP will crash because only DPs bearing [+SPECIFIC] can move there, as discussed above. (I use ∘SPECIFIC∘ to indicate this restriction that v imposes on its specifier.)

(29)



Under this analysis, when the accusative object surfaces in a clause-medial position, it must be interpreted as specific since it must raise to Spec,vP to be licensed; however, in order to move to this position, it must bear [+SPECIFIC] due to the restriction imposed on DPs moving to Spec,vP.[11]

Now consider the contrast between the fronted accusative objects of Turkish and Uyghur discussed in section 2.3. In both languages, objects can be fronted to clause-initial position. When

[10] In both Turkish and Uyghur, there is no specificity requirement on DPs that are merged as external arguments (EAs). This can be interpreted as indicating that the EA is merged in a projection above vP (see, e.g., Pylkkänen 2008), where no such requirement is imposed. Alternatively, multiple specifiers may matter here, the specificity requirement being imposed only on the innermost. In this case, the EA is merged in Spec,vP and the DO moves to Spec,vP, tucking into a lower Spec,vP (Richards 1997). Since the EA is not located in the innermost specifier, the specificity requirement is not imposed on it (there are other ways to implement this intuition, for example, by appealing to Bošković's (2016a) approach to multiple edges).

[11] Note that I keep the assumption of the standard analysis that the relevant Case licensing requires movement. This issue is discussed in more detail below in this section.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

fronted, objects must surface with accusative. In Turkish, fronted objects maintain their specific-only interpretation (12). But for such objects in Uyghur, a specific-only interpretation is not forced (14).

(12) Doktor$_i$-**u** ben t_i arı-yor-um.
doctor-ACC 1SG look.for-PROG-1SG
'I am looking for the doctor.'

(14) Doktor$_i$-**ni** men t_i izde-wat-i-men.
doctor-ACC 1SG look.for-PROG-NPST-1SG
'I am looking for the/a doctor.'

I argue that this contrast between the dislocated objects of Turkish and Uyghur is due to whether (or not) the moving DP must pass through Spec,vP. In Turkish the object must pass through this position, but in Uyghur it does not. If the object DP passes through Spec,vP, then it is subject to the constraint described by (22) and must bear [+SPECIFIC]. But if it does not, then no specificity requirement is imposed on the moving DP since it does not have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site. I argue that what determines whether DPs must pass through this position is the location of phase heads in the clause. Specifically, in Turkish v is a phase head; in Uyghur it is not. In section 4, I will provide independent evidence for this difference in phase head positions; however, at present I will adopt it as a working hypothesis.

It is standardly assumed that phrases undergoing movement are subject to locality conditions according to which movement must take place in successive steps. Specifically, an XP undergoing movement must transit through the phase edge when moving to a higher position in the structure due to the Phase Impenetrability Condition (PIC).

(30) In phase α with head H, the domain of H is not accessible to operations outside α, only H and its edge [= Spec,HP] are accessible to such operations. (Chomsky 2000: 108)

Thus, if an XP undergoes movement to Spec,ZP, and Y is a phase head intervening between XP and Spec,ZP, then Spec,YP, which is the phase edge, must be an intermediate landing site for XP, as illustrated in (31).

(31) $[_{ZP}$ XP $[\ldots [_{Z'}$ Z $[_{\mathbf{YP_{phase}}}$ ~~XP~~ $[_{Y'}$ Y $[\ldots$ ~~XP~~$]]]]]]$

Regarding which phrases count as phases, Chomsky (2000, 2001) proposes a rigid approach whereby certain phrases—namely, vP and CP—always count as phases. However, a number of authors have proposed various approaches whereby which phrases count as phases depends on the syntactic context in which they appear (see, e.g., Bobaljik and Wurmbrand 2005, Den Dikken 2007, Gallego and Uriagereka 2007, and Bošković 2014 for approaches along these lines). I adopt the version of the contextual approach proposed in Bošković 2014 where the highest element in the extended domain of a lexical head (e.g., V) delimits the phasal domain. On this approach,

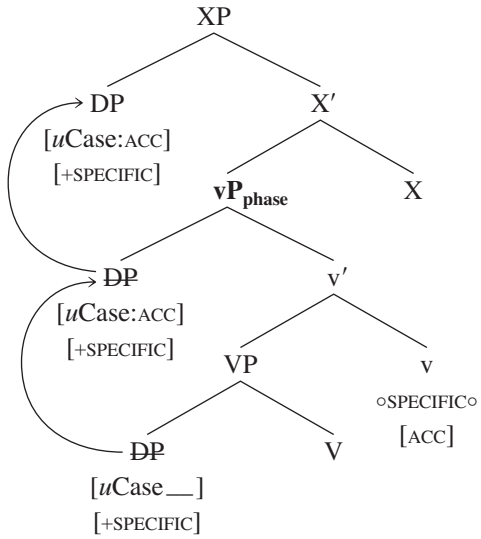
Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

vP does not have to be a phase; it is only a phase when it is the highest phrase projected in the verbal domain. If additional elements are projected above vP in this domain, vP no longer functions as a phase and the phasal domain is extended higher up.

Returning now to the contrast between the dislocated objects of Turkish (12) and Uyghur (14), consider first the Turkish case, where all dislocated objects must surface with overt case morphology and must receive a specific interpretation. If v is a phase head in Turkish, then when the DP moves to a higher position, as is the case for objects dislocated clause-initially, then the DP must have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site. But given the restriction on v that only DPs bearing the feature [+SPECIFIC] can move to Spec,vP (i.e., (22)), this means that only DPs with this feature can move to a position above Spec,vP because only those DPs can have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site. The relevant derivation is given in (32).

(32)



Now consider Uyghur, where dislocated objects surface with accusative case as well but do not have an obligatory specific interpretation. I suggest that in Uyghur, v is not a phase head. Instead, a higher functional head above v, F, fills this role (see section 4 for independent evidence to this effect). Hence, the phase boundary is above vP—namely, FP.[12] Since the phase boundary

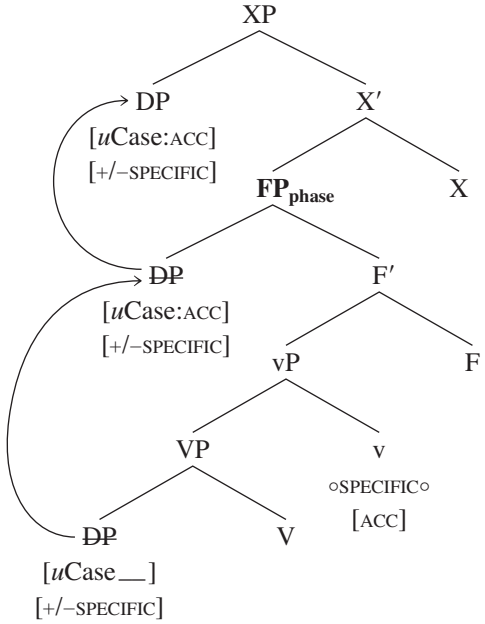
[12] The present analysis is neutral regarding the identity of F^0. I tentatively suggest that the issue may be related to a difference between the aspectual fields in Uyghur and Turkish. As Sugar (2019) shows, the Uyghur aspectual field includes both high and low (i.e., "outer" and "inner") aspectual heads (see, e.g., Travis 2010). Meanwhile, Turkish appears to lack a position associated with a low or "inner" aspectual head (but does have a position associated with a high or "outer" aspectual head; see Kornfilt 1996, Kelepir 2001, Zanon 2014, and Fenger 2020 for discussion of the Turkish aspectual field). I tentatively suggest that the presence of this lower aspectual head in Uyghur is related to the difference in phasal boundaries between the two languages—more precisely, that the presence of the lower aspectual head correlates with the phase boundary in Uyghur being located above vP. This is a speculative suggestion that obviously requires much more work (especially in the contextual phasehood approach, where particular projections do not rigidly correspond to phasal or nonphasal projections). I only note here that a number of authors have argued that aspect affects middle-field phase boundaries (see, e.g., Wurmbrand 2013, Bošković 2014, Harwood 2015, Todorovic 2016).

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

is not vP in Uyghur, moving DPs do not have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site when moving to a higher (i.e., clause-initial) position. Instead, the moving DP has Spec,FP as an intermediate landing site because this is the phase edge. But unlike Spec,vP, there are no restrictions on DPs merging to Spec,FP with respect to whether or not the DP bears [+SPECIFIC]. Thus, objects moving to clause-initial position in Uyghur, as in (14), are not forced to have the feature [+SPECIFIC] since those DPs are not forced to have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site when moving to an even higher position. The Uyghur derivation is given in (33).

(33)



Note that in this derivation, since the DP does not pass through Spec,vP, it does not receive Case in this position. Instead, I suggest that when the object DP undergoes movement to the phase edge (i.e., Spec,FP), it moves directly to this position and receives Case there. This effect (i.e., DP receiving Case from Spec,FP) can be captured on the approach to Case licensing proposed in Bošković 2007 (see also Bošković 2023 for a more recent implementation). On this approach, Case assignment is implemented in terms of a DP's [*u*Case] feature being valued via downward probing to the Case-licensing head (e.g., v). Subsequently, this probe-goal relationship is established when the DP c-commands the licensing head.[13]

[13] See Rodríguez-Mondoñedo 2007 for an implementation and independent evidence for this approach with respect to DOM. Villa-García (2015) provides further independent evidence, from Spanish, for this approach to Case. He observes that DPs that are clearly base-generated in the left periphery receive Case from a lower functional head; from this position, the DP can only probe downward to receive Case.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

In the typical case, this means that the DP raises to the specifier of the licensing head (e.g., Spec,vP) in order to receive Case. However, in instances where the DP must move to a position above the specifier of the licensing head (e.g., movement to Spec,FP), the DP moves directly to this position, where it c-commands the licensing head; it is then Case-licensed in this position in the same manner.[14] Thus, this approach to Case licensing is distinct from "traditional" Spec-head approaches to Case assignment, where a DP receives Case, and thus is licensed, only when it moves to the specifier of the licensing head (e.g., Spec,vP). Further, in section 3.4 I will argue that this effect—where the DP moves directly to the phase edge (e.g., Spec,FP) and receives Case in this position—is due to a more general effect where DPs undergoing movement to a phase edge position do not move to intermediate positions along their movement path, even if such movement is typically otherwise required (e.g., for Case licensing). Thus, such an approach to Case licensing is independently necessary in order to capture these facts, discussed below. For present purposes, the key point is that the DP moves directly to Spec,FP, does not have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site, and thus is not forced to bear [+SPECIFIC].

To summarize, the difference in interpretation found between the scrambled objects of Turkish and Uyghur is explained in terms of a difference in the position of the clause-medial phase (as noted above, independent evidence for this difference will be given in section 4). In Turkish, v is the phase head and thus all objects must pass through Spec,vP as an intermediate position when moving higher in the clause. Due to the restriction v imposes on the DPs that merge to its specifier, all DPs—whether clause-medial or fronted to a higher position—must have the feature [+SPECIFIC]. In Uyghur, because v is not a phase head, when a DP moves to a position above the vP it is not forced to move to Spec,vP. Thus, in this case there is no restriction on whether the DP is [+SPECIFIC].

3.3 Nonspecificity in Clause-Medial Positions

The present analysis can also explain a novel interpretive contrast between Turkish and Uyghur with respect to scrambled objects in certain clause-medial positions. In Turkish, as shown in (34a–b), the object can either follow or precede the temporal adverb *dün* 'yesterday'. In both positions, the object must be interpreted as specific and marked with accusative.

(34) a. Ali dün kitab-**ı** oku-du.
Ali yesterday book-ACC read-PST.3SG
'Ali read the book yesterday.'

[14] An alternative approach to Case licensing would be one where the object DP receives ACC-Case in situ via Agree with v's ϕ-probe, with raising of the object DP triggered by an EPP feature ([EPP]; see Chomsky 2001). Such an approach, however, would have to posit that in Uyghur, [EPP] can appear either on v or on F depending on whether the object DP undergoes scrambling or not. This is because (as shown above) all ACC-Case-marked DPs must raise out of the VP but only DPs that bear [+SPECIFIC] can raise to Spec,vP (ACC-Case-marked DPs that are [−SPECIFIC] must raise directly to Spec,FP). See Bošković to appear for an implementation of the EPP that would actually allow the needed variation.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

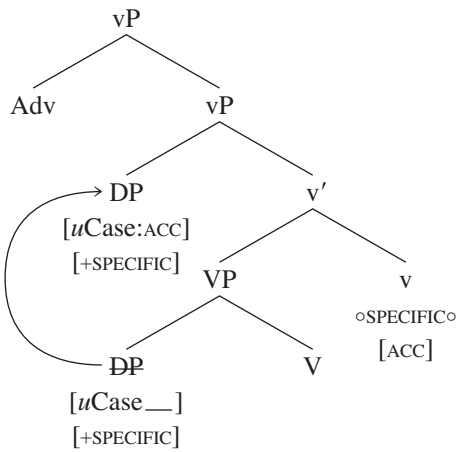
b. Ali kitab$_i$-**ı** dün t_i oku-du.
Ali book-ACC yesterday read-PST.3SG
'Ali read the book yesterday.'

Interestingly, in Uyghur the obligatory specific interpretation is enforced only when the object follows the adverb (35a), not when the object precedes the adverb (35b).

(35) a. Mehmet ete xet-**ni** yaz-i-du.
Mehmet tomorrow letter-ACC write-NPST-3SG
'Mehmet will write the letter tomorrow.'
b. Mehmet xet$_i$-**ni** ete t_i yaz-i-du.
Mehmet letter-ACC tomorrow write-NPST-3SG
'Mehmet will write the/a letter tomorrow.'

The present analysis can account for this contrast between Turkish and Uyghur. Consider first the Turkish cases in (34a–b), where the marked object is interpreted as specific when it either follows or precedes the adverb (which I assume is vP-adjoined). For (34a), the DP raises to Spec,vP to be Case-licensed and the adverb adjoins to vP. Since the DP moves to Spec,vP, it must bear [+SPECIFIC]. The relevant derivation is given in (36). In (34b), the DP must move to Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site since this is the phase edge in Turkish; thus, the DP must be [+SPECIFIC]. (The adverb adjoins to vP here as well.) The DP then scrambles from Spec,vP to a higher position above the adverb; see (37). Thus, a specific interpretation is forced for the object DPs in both (34a) and (34b).

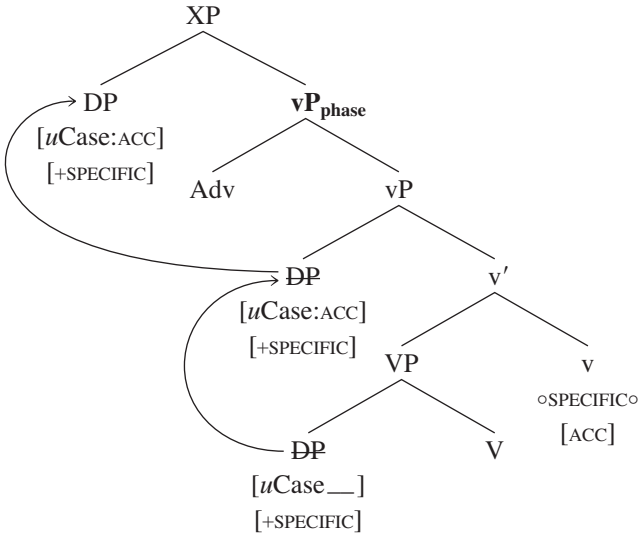
(36)



Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

(37)



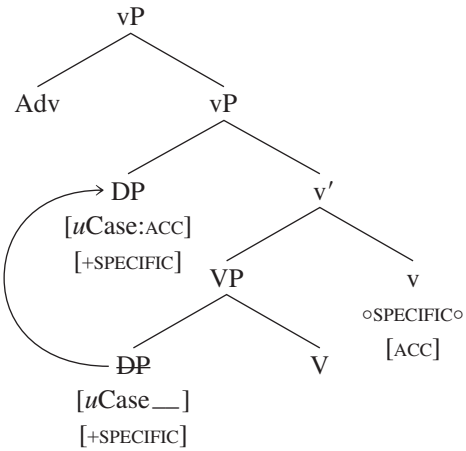
Now consider the Uyghur case. When the object DP follows the adverb (35a), it must be interpreted as specific. But when the object DP precedes the adverb (35b), it is ambiguous between specific and nonspecific interpretations. In (35a), where the object DP must be specific, it moves to Spec,vP, as discussed above, and the adverb adjoins to the vP (as in (38)). Since only DPs with the feature [+SPECIFIC] can move to this position, when the object follows the adverb only a specific interpretation is available, as expected. In (35b), however, the DP does not move to Spec,vP since it is scrambling to a position higher in the clause above the vP. Here, the adverb adjoins to the vP and the object DP moves past Spec,vP to Spec,FP as its intermediate landing site. Since the DP does not move to Spec,vP for reasons discussed above, the DP does not need to bear [+SPECIFIC]. From Spec,FP, it can scramble to its final landing site higher in the clause (as in (39)).[15]

[15] An alternative derivation for (35b) is that DP lands in Spec,FP without moving again to a higher position. Note that there is no difference between this derivation and the one described above in terms of interpretive effects of the moving DP.

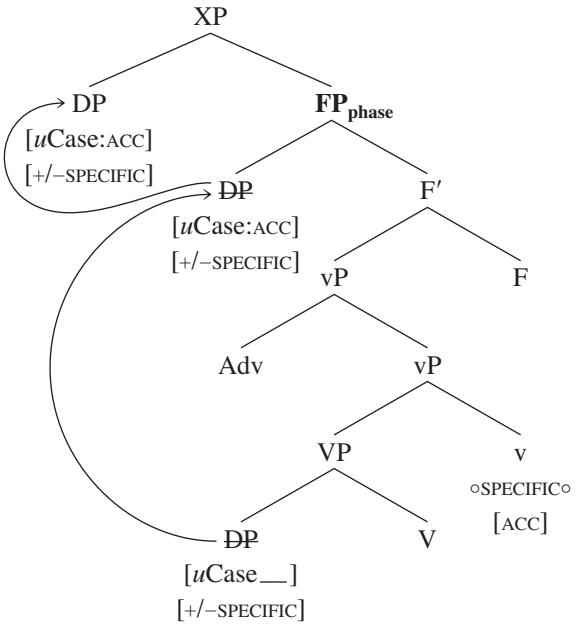
Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

(38)



(39)



3.4 Movement to the Edge

On the present analysis of Uyghur, when an object DP's final landing site is above the clause-medial phasal domain (e.g., Spec,CP), the DP moves directly from its base position to the phase edge (i.e., Spec,FP), without having Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site. Given that the DP does not move to Spec,vP before moving to Spec,FP, the question arises where the DP is Case-licensed on such derivations. In the previous section, I suggested that in such cases, the DP receives Case in Spec,FP (rather than the usual Spec,vP). In this section, I show that this is an

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

instance of a more general effect where a DP moving to a phase edge position (in a given domain) does not move to intermediate positions, even if movement to such positions is otherwise required. Instead, the DP moves directly to the phase edge and receives Case in that position. Hence, Uyghur's dislocated object DPs move directly to the phase edge, Spec,FP, and receive ACC-Case in this position.

Bošković (2007) observes this effect in the C/T domain, which directly parallels Uyghur's F/v domain. Here, while subject DPs must typically raise to Spec,TP to receive NOM-Case, if the DP undergoes movement to the phase edge, Spec,CP, it must move directly to Spec,CP without moving to Spec,TP. This effect is readily observed in English short subject questions, as in (40).

(40) Who left?

First, there is clear evidence that *wh*-subjects occupy Spec,CP as their final landing site. One such piece of evidence comes from "aggressively non-d-linked" *the hell* modification (e.g., Ginzburg and Sag 2000, Pesetsky and Torrego 2001). It has been observed that *wh*-objects can only take *the hell* modification when they have been fronted to Spec,CP; they cannot take it in situ. This contrast can be seen in (41a–b). The grammaticality of (41c) indicates that its *wh*-phrase has undergone *wh*-movement.

(41) a. What the hell did you buy?
b. *Who bought what the hell?
c. Who the hell bought a car?

Furthermore, as a number of authors have shown, movement to Spec,TP cannot feed movement to Spec,CP (see McCloskey 2000, Bošković 2016b, Messick 2020). Consider the following examples from West Ulster English:

(42) a. What did he say (all) that he wanted (all)?
b. Who was arrested all in Duke Street?
c. *They were arrested all last night.
(McCloskey 2000:61, 72, 76)

In addition to allowing the quantifier float under A-movement found in Standard English, West Ulster English can float a quantifier under *wh*-movement, as shown by (42a), where the *wh*-phrase has undergone movement to the matrix Spec,CP and the first floated *all* is stranded in the intermediate landing site of the embedded Spec,CP (sentence-final floating is also possible). Further, McCloskey (2000) observes that, with *wh*-movement, the quantifier *all* can be floated postverbally in passives (42b). However, as in Standard English, quantifier float is still not possible in (42c), indicating that *all* cannot be floated postverbally under movement to Spec,TP. However, the acceptability of (42b) indicates that the *wh*-element is not passing through Spec,TP. If it were, then *all* would be floated under movement to Spec,TP, which (42c) shows is not possible. Given this contrast, McCloskey (2000) concludes that the *wh*-subject in (42b) moves to Spec,CP without passing through Spec,TP.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Further evidence for the absence of Spec,TP-to-Spec,CP movement comes from agreement morphology in a number of languages, including Kinande. As shown in (43a), in Kinande typically an agreement prefix that is controlled by (i.e., agrees with) the subject is present on the verb. However, in the case of a *wh*-subject the usual agreement prefix is absent and an anti-agreement prefix must surface on the verb, as in (43b); compare (43c).

(43) a. Kambale **a.**langira Marya.
Kambale AGR.saw Mary
'Kambale saw Mary.'
b. Iyondi yo **u.**langira Marya?
who C ANTI-AGR.saw Mary
'Who saw Mary?'
c. *Iyondi yo **a.**langira Marya?
who C AGR.saw Mary
(Intended) 'Who saw Mary?'
(Schneider-Zioga 2007:404)

This alternation in agreement can be regarded as a morphological reflex of whether or not the subject DP is located in Spec,TP (Bošković 2016b). In (43a), the subject DP raises to Spec,TP (which is standardly assumed to be required for NOM-Case licensing in Kinande, which disallows postverbal subjects), and thus agreement morphology is present. For the *wh*-subject in (43b), the DP has not moved to Spec,TP; hence, the anti-agreement marker is realized. Note further that agreement with the *wh*-subject is impossible here (43c), indicating that the DP cannot move to Spec,TP in this case. Thus, the Kinande facts further indicate that, as a general point, DP-movement from Spec,TP to Spec,CP is not possible—even if movement to Spec,TP is otherwise required.

The above data show that a DP undergoing movement to a phase edge position (e.g., Spec,CP), cannot have intermediate licensing positions (e.g., Spec,TP) along its movement path. Instead, the DP moves directly to the phase edge, Spec,CP (after which it receives Case under Bošković's (2007) approach to Case licensing adopted here; see the discussion in section 3.2). In the case of English (and Kinande), subject DPs typically must move to Spec,TP. But when the subject DP undergoes *wh*-movement to Spec,CP, it does not have Spec,TP as an intermediate landing site and moves directly to Spec,CP.

In this respect, object movement in Uyghur's F/v domain parallels subject movement in the C/T domain. As was shown for the C/T domain, when a DP undergoes movement to a phase edge position, it must move directly to that position, even if movement to a nonphasal intermediate position would otherwise be required. In Uyghur, the object DP typically raises to Spec,vP in order to receive ACC-Case. But when the object undergoes movement to the phase edge, Spec,FP, it does not have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site; instead, it moves directly to Spec,FP, receiving ACC-Case in this position. Thus, both the West Ulster quantifier float pattern and the Kinande agreement pattern are instances of a more general constraint that DPs moving to a phase edge position (i.e., Spec,CP/Spec,FP) must move directly to this position without stopping in

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

non-phase-edge positions right below (Spec,TP/Spec,vP), although they otherwise do move to these positions.[16]

3.5 Summary

To summarize, this is what has been established so far. First, I demonstrated that existing analyses of DOM cannot account for Uyghur's pattern. The critical issue is that on standard accounts, a specific-only interpretation of a DP and its height relative to the VP are tightly correlated, predicting that if a DP has moved outside of the VP, then it must be [+SPECIFIC]. Uyghur's dislocated-object facts present a clear counterexample to this, however. For Uyghur, when an object DP appears in one position, Spec,vP, it must receive a specific interpretation (as is the case in Turkish). But when that DP moves to an even higher position, above vP, it loses the obligatory specific interpretation. This contrasts with Turkish, where objects marked with accusative case receive a uniform specific-only interpretation no matter what position they appear in. In other words, in Turkish, regardless of whether the DP is located in Spec,vP or an even higher position, it must bear the feature [+SPECIFIC].

I argued that this contrast between the dislocated objects of Turkish and Uyghur shows that the connection between a DP's derivational height and its interpretation should not simply be VP-externality. Instead, the correlation is whether the DP has moved to a particular structural position: Spec,vP. Finally, I showed that the contrast between the scrambled objects of Turkish and Uyghur can be explained in terms of a more general point of variation between the two languages: namely, whether v is a phase head or not (independent evidence for this is presented in section 4). In Turkish, v is a phase head; thus, all object DPs must have Spec,vP as either their final or an intermediate landing site when evacuating the VP. In Uyghur, v is not a phase head; rather, a higher functional projection in the extended verbal domain is. As a result, when a DP moves to a left-periphery position (as is the case with dislocated objects), it does not have to pass through Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site; hence, it does not require [+SPECIFIC] when moving to a position above vP.

[16] This parallel between the C/T and F/v domains regarding DP-licensing may be explained in terms of feature inheritance as proposed in Chomsky 2008. On this proposal, [*u*ϕ] features (and [EPP] or "edge" features) originate on phase heads and are inherited by the head selected by the phase head. I suggest that feature inheritance fails to occur if the relevant DP undergoes movement to the phase edge. In this case, [*u*ϕ] probes and licenses the DP from the phase head and triggers raising to its specifier due to the [EPP]. On this proposal, subject *wh*-movement to Spec,CP (skipping Spec,TP) is explained in terms of T failing to inherit [*u*ϕ] (and [EPP]) from C (since movement to the phase edge is independently required). This proposal can be directly extended to the F/v domain in Uyghur. Here, [*u*ϕ] and [EPP] would originate on the phase head F. If the DP need not undergo movement to the phase edge (i.e., Spec,FP), then [*u*ϕ] and [EPP] are inherited by v, which probes and licenses the DP (and triggers raising to Spec,vP). However, if the DP *must* move to the phase edge, Spec,FP, then feature inheritance fails and [*u*ϕ] probes and licenses the DP from F (and triggers raising to Spec,FP due to [EPP]). This account can derive the correct pattern for Uyghur's ACC-Case-marked object DPs since it is only those ACC-Case-marked object DPs that undergo scrambling that must move directly to Spec,FP. Given the discussion here, these DPs move directly to Spec,FP because F fails to pass its features to v. Further, this account can uniformly explain the observation that in both the C/T and F/v domains the DP does not move to Spec,TP/Spec,vP when it moves to the phase edge (i.e., Spec,CP/Spec,FP).

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

4 Further Evidence for Phase Variation

In the previous section, I established two points regarding Turkish and Uyghur. First, they differ with respect to which head counts as a phase head in the clausal middle-field. In Turkish, v is a phase head; in Uyghur, it is not. On the present proposal, there is additional functional material in the Uyghur verbal domain that extends the phase boundary above vP. Second, this difference in phase boundaries plays a key role with respect to DP-movement from inside the VP to higher positions. In Turkish, when a DP moves to a position above vP, it must have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site due to the PIC. However, in Uyghur the intermediate landing site is not Spec,vP; it is a position above it.

In this section, I show how this difference in phase positions between Turkish and Uyghur accounts for three additional contrasts between the two languages with respect to movement, regarding QR possibilities (section 4.1), verb-stranding ellipsis (section 4.2), and long-distance scrambling (section 4.3).

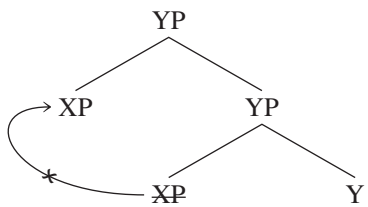
4.1 Scope Facts

As shown in (44), when associated with the focus marker *sadece* Turkish accusative objects must take wide scope over an ability modal (*-(y)Abil-*).

(44) Ali sadece sağ göz-ü-nü aç-abil-ir.
Ali only right eye-3POSS-ACC open-ABIL-AOR.3SG
'It is only his right eye that Ali can open.' (*only* DP > *can*; **can* > *only* DP)

The wide-scope-only interpretation is easily explained as being due to the antilocality constraint on movement, that is, the well-established observation that phrasal movement cannot proceed in too-short steps (e.g., Bošković 1997, 2016b, Grohmann 2000, Abels 2003, Erlewine 2020). On the approach to antilocality proposed in Bošković 1997, a moving XP must cross at least one phrase, as schematized in (45).

(45)

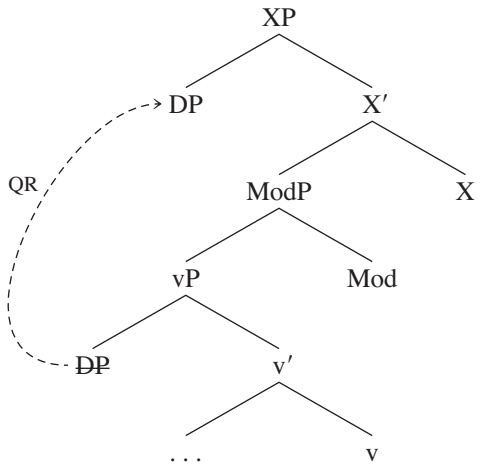


Now consider (44). As previously discussed, the object DP must move to Spec,vP. Further, it is standardly assumed that focused DPs, like quantificational phrases generally, undergo QR in LF. Thus, the object DP in (44), which has overtly moved to Spec,vP, will undergo QR from this position at LF. Crucially, antilocality considerations will force the DP to adjoin to a position above vP. Given antilocality, the object DP cannot adjoin to Spec,vP for QR, so it must adjoin either to ModP or to a position above it, as in (46). Therefore, the object DP is forced to scope over Mod.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

(46)



Uyghur presents an interesting contrast with Turkish when we consider the scope possibilities of similar constructions. In (47), the focused object DP can be interpreted as taking either wide or narrow scope relative to the ability modal *-(y)ala.*

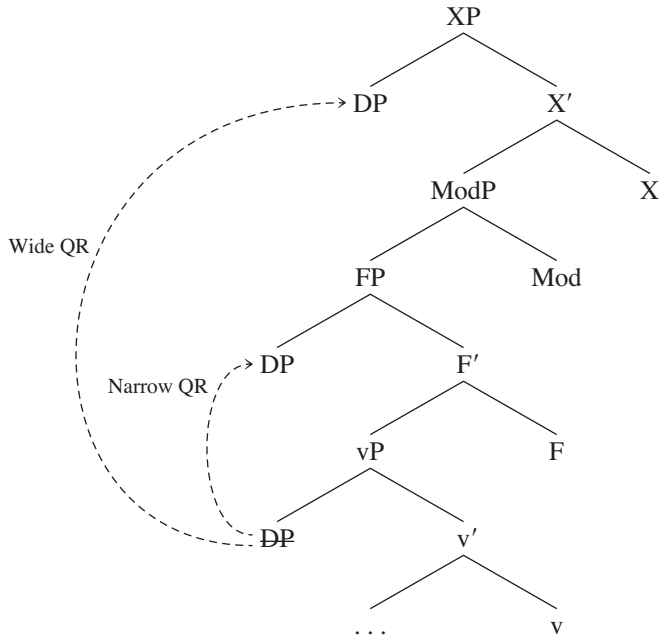
(47) Aliyë (peqet) öz-ning ong köz-i-ni-la ach-ala-y-du.
Aliyë only SELF-GEN right eye-3POSS-ACC-FOC open-ABIL-NPST-3SG
'It is only her right eye that Aliyë can open/Aliyë can open only her right eye.' (*only* DP > *can*; *can* > *only* DP)

That the object DP can have either a wide or a narrow scope interpretation can be accounted for under the proposal in section 3. Recall that the key contrast between Turkish and Uyghur is that the latter has an additional functional projection above vP, namely, FP. Now consider how this additional projection bears on the antilocality constraint. As in Turkish, the focused object DP raises to Spec,vP in overt syntax in order to be licensed. Then, in LF the DP undergoes QR to a higher position (as in Turkish). But because there is an additional functional layer FP in Uyghur, as shown in (48), the DP is free to undergo QR to Spec,FP below ModP or to a higher position above ModP, resulting in scopal ambiguity.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

(48)



Sugar (2019) shows that this kind of scopal ambiguity is not always present in Uyghur. As shown in (49), he observes that when the conative aspectual auxiliary *baq* is present, the focused DP must take wide scope over the auxiliary, generating the interpretation 'I only tried to drink tea'. (Compare the narrow scope interpretation, 'I tried to only drink tea'; see Sugar 2019 for further discussion of the relevant interpretations.)

(49) Men peqet chay-ni-la ich-ip baq-di-m.
1SG only tea-ACC-FOC drink-IP ASP.AUX-PST-1SG
'I only tried to drink tea.' (*only* DP > Aux; *Aux > *only* DP)
(Sugar 2019:220)

The obligatory wide scope interpretation of the DP in this case arises, I argue, because the aspectual head that hosts the auxiliary merges into the structure below FP; in particular, it merges with vP. Evidence that Asp merges in this position comes from the ordering of the aspectual and passive morphemes. When the auxiliary is present in a passive, the passive morpheme *-il* must attach to the auxiliary (50a); it cannot attach to the lower main verb (50b). This indicates that the aspectual auxiliary is lower than the head that hosts the passive.

(50) a. Chay-ni ich-ip baq-il-di.
tea-ACC drink-IP ASP.AUX-PASS-PST.3SG
'The tea was attempted to be drunk (by someone).'
b. *Chay-ni ich-il-ip baq-di.
tea-ACC drink-PASS-IP ASP.AUX-PST.3SG
(Intended) 'The tea was attempted to be drunk (by someone).'

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

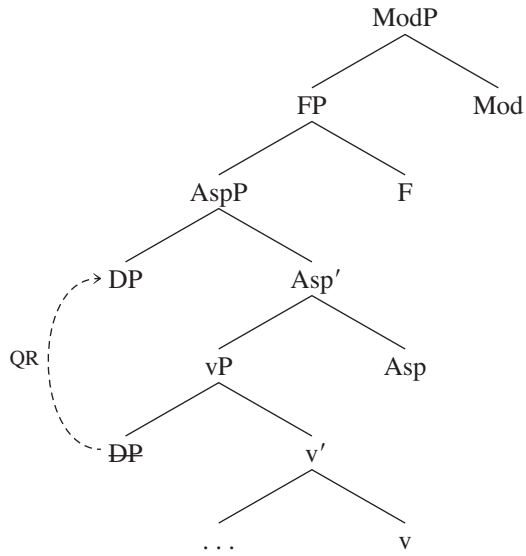
Importantly, when both the ability modal and the passive morpheme surface, as in (51a), the passive must attach below the ability modal; the ability modal cannot attach below the passive (51b). This indicates that Mod must attach to a projection above the passive-morpheme-hosting head (see Sugar 2019 for further discussion of the Merge positions of Uyghur's aspectual heads).

(51) a. Chay-ni ich-il-ala-y-du.
tea-ACC drink-PASS-ABIL.MOD-NPST-3SG
'The tea can be drunk (by someone).'
b. *Chay-ni ich-ala-il-y-du.
tea-ACC drink-ABIL.MOD-PASS-NPST-3SG
(Intended) 'The tea can be drunk (by someone).'

Therefore, given that the passive must attach above the auxiliary (50a) but below the modal (51a), this indicates that the auxiliary must merge below the modal. Further, given that the passive morpheme must follow Asp, I argue that Asp merges low in the structure; that is, it merges with vP.

Now consider how the Merge position of Asp bears on the scope possibility of the DP in (49) given the present account. Here, the object DP *overtly* raises to Spec,vP and then must *covertly* undergo QR to a higher position. In this case, however, Asp merges below FP with vP (as in (52)). Thus, when the DP undergoes QR, it must, due to antilocality, adjoin at least as high as AspP. As a result, the wide scope interpretation of the object DP relative to Asp is forced.

(52)



To conclude, the fact that Uyghur allows for scopal ambiguities with focused objects relative to an ability modal while Turkish does not is further evidence that the two languages have different phase boundaries. In Turkish, v is a phase head, which ends up forcing a wide scope interpretation for focused objects. In Uyghur, though, focused objects do admit scopal ambiguities with an ability modal. This contrast can be explained if v is not a phase head in Uyghur, with an additional

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

functional projection above vP, FP, serving as a QR landing site for the object. If the relevant scopal head merges above FP, as is the case with Mod, the DP acquires scope possibilities that would otherwise be unavailable. In the previous section, this difference accounted for the interpretive contrasts between Turkish and Uyghur with regard to scrambled objects; here, it accounts for differences in the scope possibilities of focused objects.

4.2 Verb-Stranding Ellipsis

A further contrast between Turkish and Uyghur concerns the possibility of verb-stranding ellipsis. Although the situation is relatively rare, it has been observed for several languages that VP-ellipsis is possible when the verb is stranded outside of the ellipsis site, as shown in (53) for Irish (McCloskey 1991, 2011, 2017).[17]

(53) a. Ar chuir tú isteach ar an phost?
INTERR.PST put.PST you in on the job
'Did you apply for the job?'
b. Δ chuir/ Δ níor chuir.
put.PST/ NEG.PST put.PST
'I did/I didn't.'
(McCloskey 2011:161)

Verb-stranding ellipsis is possible in Uyghur as well (see Major 2017 for discussion). As shown in (54), the objects and adjunct are elided and the main verb is stranded.

(54) Zemire Ayghül-ga sowghat-ni ettigen-de ber-di, lëkin Nilufar Δ
Zemire Ayghül-DAT gift-ACC morning-LOC give-PST.3SG but Nilufar
ewet-ti.
send-PST.3SG
'Zemire gave Ayghül a gift in the morning, but Nilufar sent ⟨Ayghül a gift in the morning⟩.'

Interestingly, verb-stranding ellipsis has been claimed not to be possible in Turkish; cases that initially appeared to be instances of such ellipsis have been argued to be instances of argument ellipsis instead. Şener and Takahashi (2010) argue that for cases such as (55), the relevant ellipsis process is argument ellipsis, where only the object DP is elided (for discussion of argument ellipsis, see Oku 1998, Saito 2007, and Sakamoto 2020, among others). They base their argument on the observation that, as indicated in (55), such ellipsis constructions do not admit a manner adjunct interpretation even when the antecedent contains such an adjunct (see (54)). The impossibility of a manner adjunct interpretation in (55) is taken to indicate that (55) cannot be an instance of verb-stranding ellipsis.

[17] Other languages that allow verb-stranding ellipsis include Persian (Rasekhi 2018), Russian (Gribanova 2013), and Uzbek (Gribanova 2020), among others.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

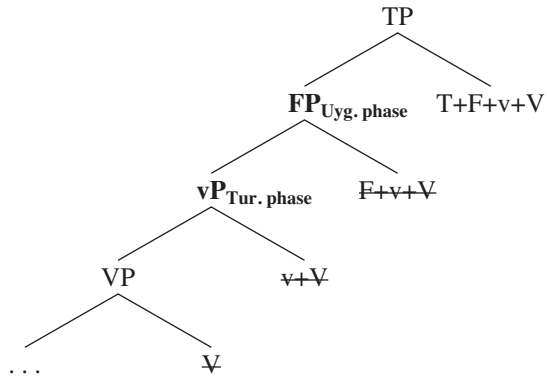
Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

(55) Kız Lego-dan kaley-i dikkatlice yap-tı ama yık-ma-dı.
girl Lego-ABL castle-ACC carefully build-PST.3SG but break-NEG-PST.3SG
'The girl carefully built the Lego castle, but she didn't ⟨*carefully⟩ break down ⟨the Lego castle⟩.'
(Fenger 2020:157)

This contrast between Turkish and Uyghur can be explained in terms of the difference in phase boundaries between the two languages, argued for above. I will suggest two analyses of these facts that depend on whether or not Turkish and Uyghur instantiate V-to-T movement. The reason for providing both analyses, one where V-to-T movement is present and one where it is not, is that whether or not V moves to T via syntactic head movement in languages such as Turkish and Uyghur is a matter of debate (see Kornfilt 1996, Kelepir 2001, Ince 2009, Zanon 2014, Major 2017, Fenger 2020).

First, suppose that both Turkish and Uyghur instantiate V-to-T syntactic head movement and that the relevant clause structure for both is as described in (56). In both languages, V raises through the same positions. However, as previously argued, in Turkish v is a phase head; in Uyghur the phase head is a higher head, F.

(56)



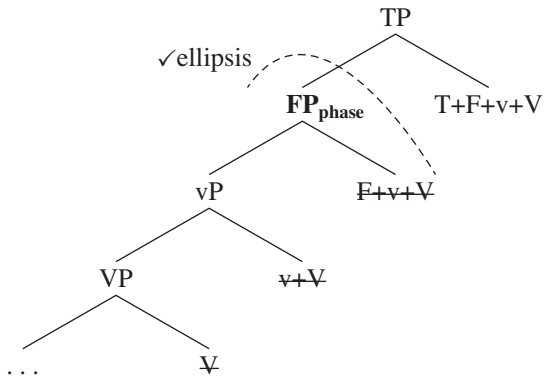
Now consider how this difference in phase positions bears on ellipsis. Bošković (2014) argues that, in principle, ellipsis can target either phase complements or entire phases. I suggest that, in the case of verb-stranding ellipsis, what is elided is the complement of T. In Uyghur, the complement of T, FP, is a phase, thus a suitable target for ellipsis (as in (57)). Here, since V raises above FP to T, it is able to escape elision. In Turkish, however, FP is not a phase. Here the phase head v is lower, and vP is not the complement of T. Thus, for Turkish, T cannot elide its complement FP because this phrase is not a phase (or a phase complement), as shown in (58).[18]

[18] Note that this analysis of verb-stranding ellipsis in Uyghur may also explain the relative rarity of languages that instantiate such ellipsis: under this analysis, such ellipsis would be possible only in languages where a higher phrase other than vP is the middle-field phase. I leave it to future research to verify this suggestion for other languages. In addition, note that this analysis (and explanation for the relative rarity of verb-stranding ellipsis) can be recast if FP is

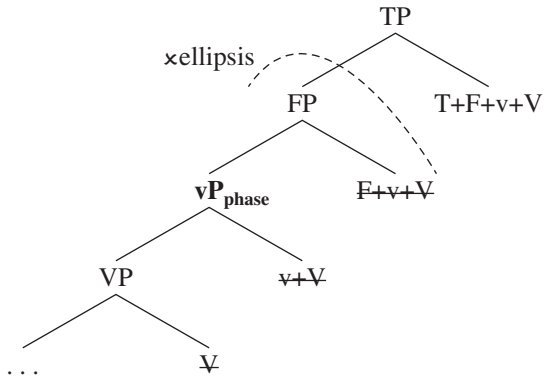
Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

(57)



(58)



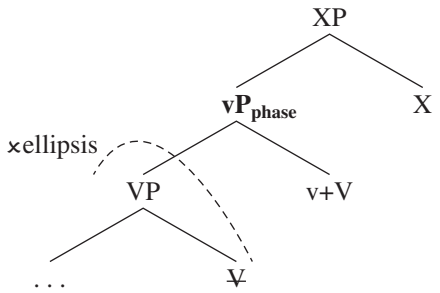
Now suppose that there is no V-to-T movement in either language. It is often assumed that vP is a phase and that V quite generally moves to v. I suggest that these are correlated in such a way that V always moves to the head position of the middle-field phase. In Turkish, the middle-field phase is vP and hence the verb moves to v; in Uyghur, it is FP and hence the verb moves to F (even though the languages do not have V-to-T movement). In languages where the verb moves to v (as in English), verb-stranding ellipsis is not allowed, which suggests that VP quite generally cannot be elided (see (59)). But in Uyghur, it is possible to elide vP and still strand V. I suggest that this is indeed what happens; that is, this is how verb-stranding ellipsis in Uyghur is derived (see (60)).

not present in Turkish at all and the complement of T is the phase vP. In this case, I suggest that verb-stranding ellipsis must involve phasal ellipsis (see Lewis to appear for another case of ellipsis constrained in this manner) and that vP cannot be elided if headed by a trace (cf. Lasnik 1999). (Note, however, that while the verb-stranding ellipsis argument is compatible with FP being either absent or present in Turkish, the scope argument in section 4.1 may require the former.)

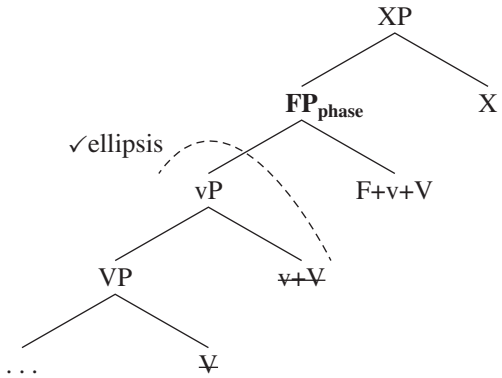
Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

(59)



(60)



To conclude, I have shown that an additional contrast between Turkish and Uyghur—that is, the possibility of verb-stranding ellipsis—can be explained in terms of a difference in phasal boundaries. In particular, I argued that Turkish disallows verb-stranding ellipsis because vP is a phase in Turkish. Uyghur allows such ellipsis because vP is not a phase; rather, a higher phrase—FP—is.

4.3 Long-Distance Scrambling

A further contrast between Turkish and Uyghur concerns the possibility of object scrambling out of embedded clauses. In constructions where the subject of the embedded clause is marked with accusative, long-distance scrambling of the embedded object is disallowed in Turkish. But in Uyghur this kind of long-distance object scrambling is generally possible. I will show below that this contrast provides further evidence for a phasal difference between Turkish and Uyghur. In particular, I will show that v's status as a phase head in Turkish blocks long-distance object scrambling over accusative subjects. But since v is not a phase head in Uyghur, this kind of movement is possible.

In Turkish and Uyghur, subjects of embedded finite clauses can optionally surface with accusative (the other option being the unmarked nominative), as in (61) and (62), respectively.

(61) a. Pelin [Ali Timbuktu-ya git-ti diye] bil-iyor-muş.
Pelin Ali Timbuktu-DAT go-PST.3SG C know-PROG-EVID.PST.3SG
'Pelin thought that Ali went to Timbuktu.'

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

b. Pelin [Ali-**yi** Timbuktu-ya git-ti diye] bil-iyor-muş.
Pelin Ali-ACC Timbuktu-DAT go-PST.3SG C know-PROG-EVID.PST.3SG
'Pelin thought that Ali went to Timbuktu.'
(adapted from Şener 2008:7)

(62) a. Adil [Mehmet ket-ti dep] bil-i-du.
Adil Mehmet leave-PST.3SG C know-NPST-3SG
'Adil knows that Mehmet left.'
b. Adil [Mehmet-**ni** ket-ti dep] bil-i-du.
Adil Mehmet-ACC leave-PST.3SG C know-NPST-3SG
'Adil knows that Mehmet left.'

Further, in both languages accusative subjects can precede matrix-level adverbs, indicating movement to the matrix clause, as in (63a) and (64a). Nominative subjects, as in (63b) and (64b), are immobile in this respect.

(63) a. Ali Can_{i}-**ı** ahmakça [t_{i} sınıf-ı geç-ti diye] düşun-üyor.
Ali Can-ACC foolishly class-ACC pass-PST.3SG C think-PRS.PROG.3SG
'Ali foolishly thinks that Can passed the class.'
b. *Ali Can_{i} ahmakça [t_{i} sınıf-ı geç-ti diye] düşun-üyor.
Ali Can foolishly class-ACC pass-PST.3SG C think-PRS.PROG.3SG
(Intended) 'Ali foolishly thinks that Can passed the class.'

(64) a. Adil Mehmet_{i}-**ni** da'im [t_{i} göshnaan et-i dep] oyla-y-du.
Adil Mehmet_{i}-ACC frequently GÖSHNAAN make-PST.3SG C think-NPST-3SG
'Adil frequently thinks that Mehmet made göshnaan.'
b. *Adil Mehmet_{i} da'im [t_{i} göshnaan et-i dep] oyla-y-du.
Adil Mehmet frequently GÖSHNAAN make-PST.3SG C think-NPST-3SG
(Intended) 'Adil frequently thinks that Mehmet made göshnaan.'

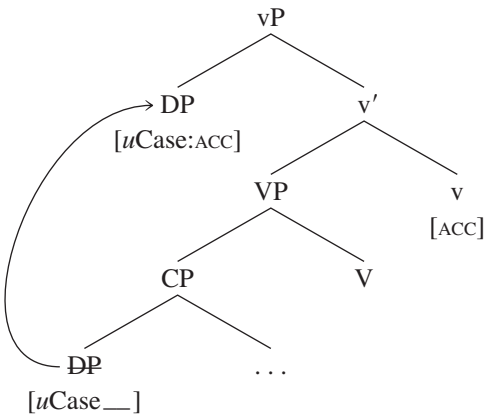
It is typically assumed that constructions like (63a)/(64a), where the embedded subject is marked accusative, involve raising to object (Kuno 1976, Kornfilt 1977, Knecht 1985, Tanaka 2002, Zidani-Eroğlu 1997a, Major 2021). Here, as shown in (65), the DP has moved from the embedded CP to a matrix position, Spec,vP, in order to be licensed by the matrix v, which accounts for both movement into the matrix clause and accusative case morphology.[19]

[19] Note that Major's (2021) analysis of Uyghur's raising-to-object constructions treats *dep* as a verbal element that heads a vP/VP layer below the matrix VP and selects for CP (with a null C; the ACC-Case-marked object still raises to Spec,vP). Regarding the discussion below, nothing would essentially change if this analysis instead of (65) were adopted for Uyghur.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

(65)



For several languages with such constructions, accusative subjects block scrambling of other elements from the embedded clause. For example, this is the case in Japanese. Like Turkish and Uyghur, Japanese allows embedded subjects to be marked with accusative (66b).[20]

(66) a. Taroo-wa [Hanako-ga tesai da to] omotteiru.
Taroo-TOP Hanako-NOM genius COP C think.PROG
'Taroo thinks Hanako is a genius.'
b. Taroo-wa [Hanako-**o** tesai da to] omotteiru.
Taroo-TOP Hanako-ACC genius COP C think.PROG
'Taroo thinks Hanako is a genius.'
(Taguchi 2015:22)

Interestingly, when the subject is marked with accusative, it blocks the object from scrambling out of the embedded clause (67a) (Yoo 2018). Nominative subjects, on the other hand, allow such scrambling (67b).

(67) a. *Gengoaku$_i$-ni John-ga [Mary-**o** t_i kuwashii to] omotteiru.
linguistics-DAT John-NOM Mary-ACC familiar C think.PROG
(Intended) 'With linguistics, John thinks that Mary is familiar.'
b. Gengoaku$_i$-ni John-ga [Mary-**ga** t_i kuwashii to] omotteiru.
linguistics-DAT John-NOM Mary-NOM familiar C think.PROG
'With linguistics, John thinks that Mary is familiar.'
(Bošković 2021)

[20] Note that this nominative/accusative alternation observed with embedded subjects in Japanese is distinct from the nominative/accusative alternation observed with DOs, which is a clause-internal phenomenon. For discussion see, among others, Kuno 1973.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Turkish patterns with Japanese regarding this blocking effect (Zidani-Eroğlu 1997a, Aygen 2002). When the embedded subject is accusative, it blocks the object from scrambling out of the embedded clause (68a). When the embedded subject is nominative, the object can scramble out (68b).[21]

(68) a. *Oya$_i$-ya Ali Ayşe-yi t_i yardım et-ti san-ıyor.
Oya-DAT Ali Ayşe-ACC help do-PST.3SG believe-PRES.PROG.3SG
(Intended) 'Ali believes Ayşe to have helped Oya.'
b. Oya$_i$-ya Ali Ayşe t_i yardım et-ti san-ıyor.
Oya-DAT Ali Ayşe help do-PST.3SG believe-PRES.PROG.3SG
'Ali believes Ayşe to have helped Oya.'

Yoo (2018) proposes an account of the blocking effect for Japanese based on Richards's (1997) tucking-in effect that can be straightforwardly extended to Turkish. Richards (1997) shows that quite generally in cases where a specifier is already present, when a new specifier is created for a head it must be created below or "tuck in" below the existing one, as in (69).

(69) $[_{YP}$ XP ZP XP $[_{Y'}$ Y [. . . ~~XP~~]]]

Assuming that Turkish accusative subjects are instances of raising to object (i.e., (65)), the embedded subject DP moves to the matrix Spec,vP. When the embedded object DP scrambles out of the embedded clause to the left periphery of the matrix clause, it must have the matrix Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site due to the PIC. However, because the specifier of the matrix v is already occupied by the raised DP, the scrambling embedded object DP must tuck in below the raised DP when creating a specifier. Further, Bošković (2016a) shows that quite generally in multiple-specifier configurations, only the outermost specifier counts as the phase edge with respect to the PIC.[22] Because the scrambling object DP must tuck in below the raised DP, it is not at the edge of the vP phase and movement to a higher position is thus blocked due to the PIC. This effect is illustrated in (70) for the Japanese and Turkish examples in (67a) and (68a).

[21] As an anonymous reviewer notes, many native speakers of Turkish observe a contrast between long-distance scrambling an oblique object over an accusative subject (as in (68a)) and long-distance scrambling an accusative object over an accusative subject, judging the former as less degraded than the latter (although both are still more degraded than the grammatical cases where the object scrambles long-distance over a nominative subject, as in (68b)). As the reviewer suggests, this indicates that performance factors may play a role regarding the ungrammaticality of long-distance scrambling over accusative subjects. Importantly for the present point, the crucial observation is that long-distance scrambling over an accusative subject in general is more degraded than over a nominative subject, suggesting that formal syntax plays a role (along with performance factors).

[22] Note that, as Bošković (2016a) argues, this outermost edge effect only applies to multiple-specifier configurations where the highest specifier is occupied by a DP that heads a chain. In other words, the effect is neutralized if the highest specifier is occupied by a lower copy (i.e., trace) in a chain (on a par with Relativized Minimality effects). In the present case, this means that the matrix subject DP, which is presumably generated in the matrix Spec,vP, does not count as an edge position with respect to the outermost edge effect.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

(70) $[_{XP}\ DP_{obj}\ [_{\mathbf{vP_{phase}}}\ DP_{subj}\ DP_{obj}\ [_{v'}\ [VP\ [_{CP}\ \cancel{DP}_{subj}\ \cancel{DP}_{obj}\ [_{C'}\ \ldots\ C]]\ V]\ v\ ]]\ \ldots\ ]$

Tucking-in

Conversely, when the embedded subject DP is nominative, as in (67b) and (68b) for Japanese and Turkish, respectively, it is located in the embedded Spec,TP and does not raise to the matrix Spec,vP. Thus, no blocking effect is induced because the embedded object DP is not required to have the embedded Spec,TP—a non-phase-edge position—as an intermediate landing site when moving to the matrix clause. Further, when the embedded object DP moves to the matrix Spec,vP, it is no longer blocked from further movement since there is no DP in Spec,vP (see footnote 21) forcing the scrambling object to tuck in below (cf. (70)). (71) gives the relevant derivation.

(71) $[_{XP}\ DP_{obj}\ [_{\mathbf{vP_{phase}}}\ \cancel{DP}_{obj}\ [_{v'}\ [_{VP}\ [_{CP}\ \cancel{DP}_{obj}\ [_{C'}\ [_{TP}\ DP_{subj}\ [_{T'}\ [_{vP}\ \cancel{DP}_{obj}\ \ldots\ ]\ T]]\ C]]\ V]\ v]]\ \ldots\ ]$

The present analysis of the interpretive difference between the accusative objects of Turkish and Uyghur makes an interesting prediction regarding the possibility of long-distance scrambling. As discussed in section 4.2, in Uyghur vP is not a phase. Instead, the phase boundary is a higher functional projection, FP. Since vP is not a phase, moving DPs are not required to have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site when moving to a position higher in the clause. Since the phase edge is Spec,FP, if a DP is located in the matrix Spec,vP, it should not induce a blocking effect for other DPs moving above the matrix vP, as discussed above with respect to Turkish and Japanese. Since vP is not a phase in Uyghur, the forced tucking-in at the vP phase edge that creates a problem in Turkish and Japanese does not take place here. Hence, in Uyghur (unlike Japanese and Turkish) accusative subjects should not induce a blocking effect with regard to objects scrambling out of the embedded CP. The surprising prediction—that in contrast to Turkish, Uyghur's accusative subject will not block object scrambling—is in fact borne out in (72b) (see also Major 2014).

(72) a. Adil Mehmet-ni Aliyë-gë yerdem ber-di dep angli-di.
Adil Mehmet-ACC Aliyë-DAT help give-PST.3SG C hear-PST.3SG
'Adil heard that Mehmet helped Aliyë.'

b. Aliyë$_i$-gë Adil Mehmet-ni t_i yerdem ber-di dep angli-di.
Aliyë-DAT Adil Mehmet-ACC help give-PST.3SG C hear-PST.3SG
'Adil heard that Mehmet helped Aliyë.'

The possibility of long-distance scrambling in Uyghur (but not Turkish) is thus predicted under the hypothesis that vP is not a phase in Uyghur. Since it is not, the moving object DP need not move to Spec,vP, a movement that creates a problem in Turkish. Conversely, since vP is a phase in Turkish and Spec,vP is therefore the phase edge, accusative subjects in matrix Spec,vP induce a blocking effect for object scrambling.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

4.4 Summary

To summarize, I have shown that four otherwise unrelated contrasts between Turkish and Uyghur can be given a uniform account under the hypothesis that the two languages differ with respect to phase boundaries in the middle field. In section 3.2, I explained the interpretive contrasts concerning specificity between the dislocated objects of Turkish and Uyghur in these terms: namely, because in Turkish but not in Uyghur, dislocated object DPs must have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site. In this section, I discussed three further contrasts, in scope possibilities, verb-stranding ellipsis, and long-distance scrambling. All three contrasts can be explained in the same terms as the dislocated objects: location of phase heads. In Turkish, v is a phase head; in Uyghur, it is not.

5 Phasal Variation beyond Turkic

One of the key claims so far has been that several contrasts between Turkish and Uyghur can be explained in terms of a single point of crosslinguistic variation: whether or not vP is a phase. Given that Turkish and Uyghur exhibit this kind of phasal variation, we may expect other languages to exhibit phenomena that can be traced to this point of variation as well. Here, I argue that this is indeed the case, for two languages unrelated to Turkic: Swahili and Bemba.

Swahili presents a case where DPs undergoing movement to a higher position must pass through Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site. Here, objects that are high in animacy must agree with the verb, which surfaces with an agreement marker controlled by the object (Henderson 2006, Riedel 2009). As shown in (73a–b), the verb surfaces with a marker agreeing in noun class with the object.

(73) a. Ni-li-*(**mw**)-ona mtoto.
SM.1SG-PST-1.OM-see 1.child
'I saw a/the child.'
(Riedel 2009:68)

b. Juma a-li-*(**wa**)-kutana walimu.
Juma SM.3SG-PST-2.OM-meet 2.teachers
'Juma met the teachers.'
(Henderson 2006:61)

Further, when the animate object undergoes movement to a position higher in the clause, as in object relativization, object agreement is required on the verb as well, as in (74a–b) (Henderson 2006, Riedel 2009).

(74) a. msichana amba-ye Juma a-li-*(**m**)-kutana jana
1.girl AMBA-1.REL Juma SM.3SG-PST-1.OM-meet yesterday
'the girl that Juma met yesterday'

b. watoto amba-o Juma a-li-*(**wa**)-ona
2.children AMBA-2.REL Juma SM.3SG-PST-2.OM-see

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

'the children that Juma saw'
(Henderson 2006:58, 192)

As Woolford (1999, 2001) argues, the presence of object agreement with animates, as in (73a–b), indicates that the DP raises out of the VP to a higher licensing position; that is, the presence of object agreement is a reflex of the DP moving to Spec,vP. Further, when the object DP undergoes relativization, as in (74a–b), the object agreement marker remains. Given that object agreement is also a requirement for animate DPs that undergo movement to a position higher in the clause (i.e., Spec,CP), we may regard this as evidence that in Swahili vP is a phase and, thus, that a moving object DP must have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site due to the PIC. As a result of this intermediate movement step, a morphological reflex—object agreement—is present.

The key point for our purposes is that Swahili parallels Turkish regarding phase boundaries. In both cases, vP is a phase and therefore all elements must have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site when moving to a higher position. In Swahili, this has a morphological reflex in agreement. In Turkish, the reflex is the moving object's obligatory specific interpretation.

Now consider Bemba, whose object agreement pattern contrasts sharply with that of the related language Swahili. As shown in (75), the verb surfaces with an agreement marker that is controlled by the object. However, when the object undergoes movement to a position higher in the clause, as in the case of object relatives (76a), the verb cannot agree with the object; compare (76b) (Marten, Kula, and Thwala 2007, Zeller 2014).

(75) N-álì-mú-món-á Chìsángá.
1SG.SM-PST-1.OM-see-FV 1.Chisanga
'I saw Chisanga.'
(Marten, Kula, and Thwala 2007:261)

(76) a. ìcí-pùnà ícò ùmù-ánàkáshì á-mwèènè
7-chair REL.7 1-girl SM1-see.PERF
'the chair that the girl saw'
b. *ìcí-pùnà ícò ùmù-ánàkáshì á-**ci**-mwèènè
7-chair REL.7 1-girl SM1-7.OM-see.PERF
'the chair that the girl saw'
(Marten, Kula, and Thwala 2007:275)

I suggest that these facts indicate that in transitive constructions, like (75), the DO raises to Spec,vP. Then, agreement morphology is a reflex of the DO's presence in Spec,vP. However, when the DO undergoes Ā-movement, as with object relatives (76a), the DP does not pass through Spec,vP; hence, there is no morphological reflex—that is, there is no object agreement.[23] I suggest that this indicates that in Bemba, as in Uyghur, v is not a phase head and therefore, when a DP

[23] See also Bošković 2008, 2016b for a similar analysis of Kinande's object agreement patterns, which parallel Bemba's in several important respects regarding obligatory object agreement drop under Ā-movement (see also Schneider-Zioga 1995 regarding Kinande).

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

is moving to a position above vP, it does not have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site. In this respect, Bemba's agreement facts parallel Uyghur's facts regarding the interpretation of moving objects. In both, when an object moves to Spec,vP, a reflex is present. For Uyghur, it is an obligatory specific interpretation of the DP, and for Bemba, it is object agreement. But in both cases, when the object moves to a position above vP, the object does not move to Spec,vP and the reflexes are absent. In Uyghur, the object loses its obligatory specific interpretation; in Bemba, object agreement is absent.

It should be noted that Icelandic object shift may provide another parallel with Uyghur and Bemba, given the data regarding d-linked interpretation of *wh*-phrases discussed in footnote 9. As noted there, the d-linked interpretation of a *wh*-phrase that is forced under object shift is not forced under further movement, indicating that the *wh*-phrase does not pass through the position that is associated with object shift in Icelandic under *wh*-movement. In fact, as observed in section 2.3, exactly the same pattern is found with respect to accusative-marked *wh*-objects in Uyghur.

As shown above, the contrast between Swahili and Bemba with regard to object agreement can be viewed as a morphological parallel to the contrast between the interpretive possibilities of the dislocated objects of Turkish and Uyghur. In both cases, when an object moves to Spec,vP, a reflex is present, either morphological or semantic. For Turkish and Swahili, this reflex is present even when the object's final landing site is higher than Spec,vP, indicating that objects must have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site when undergoing overt movement above vP. In Uyghur and Bemba, this is not the case. Here, when objects undergo overt movement higher in the clause (i.e., above vP), the reflex is absent. As we have seen, this can be captured if in Turkish and Swahili v is a phase head and if in Uyghur and Bemba it is not. It is worth emphasizing here that Swahili and Bemba are related languages, just like Turkish and Uyghur—what we have here, then, are pairs of related languages showing the same variation regarding phasal boundaries, differing only in its morphological/semantic reflex.

6 Conclusion

In this article, I have established a new DOM paradigm by comparing the DOM systems in Turkish and Uyghur. On the basis of this comparison, I have argued for several related points. First, I have argued that the standard assumption that specificity and VP-externality always correlate with one another is incorrect. While Turkish patterns in this way, I showed that Uyghur presents a clear counterexample. In Uyghur, when DOM objects surface in their clause-medial, VP-external position, they must be specific. But upon further movement to an even higher position, they lose this obligatory specific interpretation. Thus, I conclude that a DP's height relative to the VP (i.e., VP-externality) is not a reliable guide to determining whether an object DP must receive a specific interpretation.

Second, I presented an analysis of specificity effects that captures both the Turkish and the Uyghur patterns. On the standard approach, movement of the object DP outside of the VP is forced only when the DP bears the feature [+SPECIFIC]. This idea can be implemented in a number of ways; however, the crucial point is that on such accounts, if a DP is VP-external, then it must receive a specific interpretation—a requirement I showed to be problematic. In view of this

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

problem for the standard approach, I suggested that what forces a DP to receive an obligatory specific interpretation is whether or not it occupies a particular position, namely, Spec,vP. I argued that this account of specificity effects, combined with variation in the two languages' phase position, explains the differences between their DOM patterns. In Turkish, vP is a phase, but in Uyghur, it is not. As a result, in Turkish all objects that move outside of the VP must have Spec,vP as either their final or an intermediate landing site. Hence, they are always specific. But since in Uyghur the phase boundary is higher than Spec,vP, this is not the case: if an object moves above the phase, then it does not have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site, and thus, no specificity effect is induced.

Third, I showed how this point of variation between Turkish and Uyghur—whether or not vP (or a higher phrase in the middle field) is a phase—can also explain contrasts between the two languages regarding scope effects, verb-stranding ellipsis, and the possibility of long-distance object scrambling. Thus, the proposed difference in phase boundaries provides a uniform account of four otherwise unrelated differences between Turkish and Uyghur.

Finally, I showed that this point of variation between the phase positions of Turkish and Uyghur is observed crosslinguistically. Here, I compared Swahili and Bemba's object agreement patterns. I argued that in Swahili, successive-cyclic movement proceeds in the same way as in Turkish. Since vP is a phase in both languages, when a DP moves from within the VP to a position above vP, the DP must have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site. This is reflected in Turkish with specificity effects and in Swahili with the presence of object agreement. Conversely, in Bemba an object DP does not have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site when moving to a higher position. I argued that this is because, as in Uyghur, vP is not a phase; thus, when the DP moves to a higher position, it is not required to have Spec,vP as an intermediate landing site. This is reflected in Uyghur with the absence of obligatory specific interpretations for scrambled objects and in Bemba with the absence of object agreement under object relativization. Thus, the phasal variation observed in Turkish and Uyghur is an instance of a more general crosslinguistic point of variation.

References

Abels, Klaus. 2003. Successive cyclicity, anti-locality, and adposition stranding. Doctoral dissertation, University of Connecticut.

Adger, David, and Daniel Harbour. 2007. Syntax and syncretisms of the Person Case Constraint. *Syntax* 10:2–37.

Asarina, Alevtina. 2011. Case in Uyghur and beyond. Doctoral dissertation, MIT.

Aygen, Gülşat. 2002. Finiteness, case and clausal architecture. Doctoral dissertation, Harvard University.

Baker, Mark. 2015. *Case: Its principles and parameters.* Cambridge University Press.

Baker, Mark, and Nadya Vinokurova. 2010. Two modalities of case assignment: Case in Sakha. *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory* 28:593–642.

Berent, Gerald. 1980. On the realization of trace: Macedonian clitic pronouns. In *Morphosyntax in Slavic*, ed. by Catherine Chvany and Richard Brecht, 150–186. Slavica Publishers.

Bhatt, Rajesh, and Elena Anagnostopoulou. 1996. Object shift and specificity: Evidence from *ko*-phrases in Hindi. In *CLS 32: Papers from the Main Session*, ed. by Lise Dobrin, Lisa McNair, and Kora Singer, 11–22. University of Chicago, Chicago Linguistic Society.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Bobaljik, Jonathan David, and Susi Wurmbrand. 2005. The domain of agreement. *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory* 23:809–865.

Boeckx, Cedric, and Kleanthes K. Grohmann. 2004. SubMove: Towards a unified account of scrambling and d-linking. In *Peripheries: Syntactic edges and their effects*, ed. by David Adger, Cécile De Cat, and George Tsoulas, 241–257. Springer.

Bošković, Željko. 1997. *The syntax of nonfinite complementation: An economy approach.* MIT Press.

Bošković, Željko. 2007. On the locality and motivation of Move and Agree: An even more minimal theory. *Linguistic Inquiry* 38:589–644.

Bošković, Željko. 2008. On successive cyclic movement and the freezing effect of feature checking. In *Sounds of silence: Empty elements in syntax and phonology*, ed. by Jutta Hartmann, Veronika Hegedűs, and Henk C. van Riemsdijk, 195–233. Elsevier.

Bošković, Željko. 2014. Now I'm a phase, now I'm not a phase: On the variability of phases with extraction and ellipsis. *Linguistic Inquiry* 45:27–89.

Bošković, Željko. 2016a. Getting really edgy: On the edge of the edge. *Linguistic Inquiry* 47:1–33.

Bošković, Željko. 2016b. On the timing of labeling: Deducing Comp-trace effects, the Subject Condition, the Adjunct Condition, and tucking in from labeling. *The Linguistic Review* 33:17–66.

Bošković, Željko. 2021. Broadening and localizing the Comp-trace effect and the contextuality of the EPP. Handout from a talk presented at the 39th West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics, University of Arizona, 8–11 April.

Bošković, Željko. 2023. Merge, Move, and contextuality of syntax: The role of labeling, successive-cyclicity, and EPP effects. Ms., University of Connecticut.

Bošković, Željko. To appear. The Comp-trace effect and contextuality of the EPP. In *WCCFL 39: Proceedings of the 39th West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics.* Cascadilla.

Browne, Wayles. 1970. Noun phrase definiteness in relatives and questions: Evidence from Macedonian. *Linguistic Inquiry* 1:267–270.

Chomsky, Noam. 2000. Minimalist inquiries: The framework. In *Step by step: Essays on Minimalist syntax in honor of Howard Lasnik*, ed. by Roger Martin, David Michaels, and Juan Uriagereka, 89–155. MIT Press.

Chomsky, Noam. 2001. Derivation by phase. In *Ken Hale: A life in language*, ed. by Michael Kenstowicz, 1–52. MIT Press.

Chomsky, Noam. 2008. On phases. In *Foundational issues in linguistic theory: Essays in honor of Jean-Roger Vergnaud*, ed. by Robert Freidin, Carlos Otero, and Maria Luisa Zubizarreta, 133–166. MIT Press.

Comorovski, Ileana. 1996. *Interrogative phrases and the syntax-semantics interface.* Springer.

Danon, Gabi. 2006. Caseless nominals and the projection of DP. *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory* 24:977–1008.

Dede, Müserref. 1986. Definiteness and referentiality in Turkish verbal sentences. In *Studies in Turkish linguistics*, ed. by Dan Slobin and Karl Zimmer, 147–164. John Benjamins.

Diesing, Molly. 1992. *Indefinites.* MIT Press.

Diesing, Molly. 1996. Semantic variables and object shift. In *Studies in comparative Germanic syntax*, ed. by Höskuldur Thráinsson, Samuel David Epstein, and Steve Peter, 2:66–84. Kluwer.

Diesing, Molly, and Eloise Jelinek. 1995. Distributing arguments. *Natural Language Semantics* 3:123–176.

Dikken, Marcel den. 2007. Phase extension: Contours of a theory of the role of head movement in phrasal extraction. *Theoretical Linguistics* 33:1–41.

Enç, Mürvet. 1991. The semantics of specificity. *Linguistic Inquiry* 22:1–25.

Erguvanlı, Eser Emine. 1984. *The function of word order in Turkish grammar.* University of California Press.

Erlewine, Michael Yoshitaka. 2020. Anti-locality and subject extraction. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 5.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Fenger, Paula. 2020. Words within words: The internal syntax of verbs. Doctoral dissertation, University of Connecticut.
Gallego, Ángel, and Juan Uriagereka. 2007. Sub-extraction from subjects. In *Romance linguistics 2006: Selected papers from the 36th Symposium on Romance Languages*, ed. by José Camacho, Nydia Flores-Ferrán, Liliana Sánchez, Viviane Déprez, and María José Cabrera, 149–162. John Benjamins.
Ginzburg, Jonathan, and Ivan Sag. 2000. *Interrogative investigations.* CSLI Publications.
Gribanova, Vera. 2013. Verb-stranding verb phrase ellipsis and the structure of the Russian verbal complex. *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory* 31:91–136.
Gribanova, Vera. 2020. Predicate formation and verb-stranding ellipsis in Uzbek. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 5.
Grohmann, Kleanthes K. 2000. Prolific peripheries: A radical view from the left. Doctoral dissertation, University of Maryland.
Grohmann, Kleanthes K. 2006. Top issues in questions: Topics-topicalization-topicalizability. In Wh-*movement: Moving on*, ed. by Lisa Lai-Shen Cheng and Norbert Corver, 249–288. MIT Press.
Hahn, Reinhard. 2015. *The Turkic languages.* London: Routledge.
Harwood, William. 2015. Being progressive is just a phase: Celebrating the uniqueness of progressive aspect under a phase-based analysis. *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory* 33:523–573.
Henderson, Brent. 2006. The syntax and typology of Bantu relative clauses. Doctoral dissertation, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign.
von Heusinger, Klaus, and Jaklin Kornfilt. 2005. The case of the direct object in Turkish: Semantics, syntax and morphology. *Turkic Languages* 9:3–44.
Ince, Atakan. 2009. Dimensions of ellipsis: Investigations in Turkish. Doctoral dissertation, University of Maryland.
Jaeger, Florian. 2004. Topicality and superiority in Bulgarian *wh*-questions. In *Proceedings of Formal Approaches to Slavic Linguistics 12*, ed. by Olga Arnaudova, Wayles Browne, María Luisa Rivero, and Danijela Stojanović, 207–228. Michigan Slavic Publications.
Kalin, Laura, and Philipp Weisser. 2019. Asymmetric DOM in coordination: A problem for movement-based approaches. *Linguistic Inquiry* 50:662–676.
Kelepir, Meltem. 2001. Topics in Turkish syntax: Clausal structure and scope. Doctoral dissertation, MIT.
Kennelly, Sarah. 1994. Caseless existential DPs in Turkish. In *Paris-8 working papers in linguistics*, ed. by Léa Nash and George Tsoulas.
Knecht, Laura. 1985. Subject and object in Turkish. Doctoral dissertation, MIT.
Kornfilt, Jaklin. 1977. A note on subject raising in Turkish. *Linguistic Inquiry* 8:736–742.
Kornfilt, Jaklin. 1996. On copular clitic forms in Turkish. In *ZAS papers in linguistics*, ed. by Artemis Alexiadou, Nanna Fuhrhop, Paul Law, and Sylvia Löhken, 96–114. Zentrum Allgemeine Sprachwissenschaft.
Kornfilt, Jaklin. 1997. *Turkish.* Routledge.
Kornfilt, Jaklin. 2003. Scrambling, subscrambling, and case in Turkish. In *Word order and scrambling*, ed. by Simin Karimi, 125–155. Blackwell.
Kornfilt, Jaklin. 2020. DOM and DSM in Turkish: Not only dependent Case, but also dependent Agree. In *Case, agreement and their interactions: New perspectives on differential object marking*, ed. by András Bárány and Laura Kalin, 127–175. De Gruyter.
Kuno, Susumu. 1973. *The structure of the Japanese language.* MIT Press.
Kuno, Susumu. 1976. Subject raising. In *Japanese generative grammar*, ed. by Masayoshi Shibatani, 17–49. Academic Press.
Laca, Brenda. 1987. Sobre el uso del acusativo preposicional en español. *Romanistisches Jahrbuch* 36: 61–92.
Lasnik, Howard. 1999. Pseudogapping puzzles. In *Fragments: Studies in ellipsis and gapping*, ed. by Shalom Lappin and Elabbas Benmamoun, 141–174. Oxford University Press.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Leonetti, Manuel. 2004. Specificity and differential object marking in Spanish. *Catalan Journal of Linguistics* 3:75–114.

Lewis, Beccy. To appear. British English *do*-ellipsis is full phase ellipsis. In *WCCFL 40: Proceedings of the 40th West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics.* Cascadilla.

López, Luis. 2012. *Indefinite objects: Scrambling, choice functions, and differential marking.* MIT Press.

Major, Travis. 2014. Syntactic islands in Uyghur. Master's thesis, University of Kansas.

Major, Travis. 2017. Uyghur contrastive polarity questions: A case of verb-stranding "TP-ellipsis." In *Proceedings of the 12th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics*, ed. by Leyla Zidani-Eroğlu, Matthew Ciscel, and Elena Koulidobrova. MIT Working Papers in Linguistics 83. MIT, MIT Working Papers in Linguistics.

Major, Travis. 2021. On the nature of 'say' complementation. Doctoral dissertation, UCLA.

Marantz, Alec. 1991. Case and licensing. In *Proceedings of the 8th Eastern States Conference on Linguistics*, ed. by Germán Westphal, Benjamin Ao, and Hee-Rahk Chae, 234–253. Cornell University, CLC Publications.

Marten, Lutz, Nancy Kula, and Nhlanhla Thwala. 2007. Parameters of morphosyntactic variation in Bantu. *Transactions of the Philological Society* 105:253–338.

Massam, Diane. 2001. Pseudo noun incorporation in Niuean. *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory* 19: 153–197.

McCloskey, James. 1991. Clause structure, ellipsis and proper government in Irish. *Lingua* 85:259–302.

McCloskey, James. 2000. Quantifier float and *wh*-movement in an Irish English. *Linguistic Inquiry* 31: 57–84.

McCloskey, James. 2011. The shape of Irish clauses. In *Formal approaches to Celtic linguistics*, ed. by Andrew Carnie, 143–178. Cambridge Scholars Publishing.

McCloskey, James. 2017. Ellipsis, polarity, and the cartography of verb-initial orders in Irish. In *Elements of comparative syntax*, ed. by Enoch Aboh, Eric Haeberli, Genoveva Puskás, and Manuela Schönenberger, 99–152. De Gruyter Mouton.

Messick, Troy. 2020. The derivation of highest subject questions and the nature of the EPP. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 5.

Oku, Satoshi. 1998. A theory of selection and reconstruction in the Minimalist perspective. Doctoral dissertation, University of Connecticut.

Ormazabal, Javier, and Juan Romero. 2013a. Differential object marking, case and agreement. *Borealis* 2: 221–239.

Ormazabal, Javier, and Juan Romero. 2013b. Non accusative objects. *Catalan Journal of Linguistics* 12: 155–173.

Öztürk, Balkız. 2005. *Case, referentiality, and phrase structure.* John Benjamins.

Pesetsky, David, and Esther Torrego. 2001. T-to-C movement: Causes and consequences. In *Ken Hale: A life in language*, ed. by Michael Kenstowicz, 355–426. MIT Press.

Pylkkänen, Liina. 2008. *Introducing arguments.* MIT Press.

Rasekhi, Vahideh. 2018. Ellipsis and information structure: Evidence from Persian. Doctoral dissertation, Stony Brook University.

Richards, Norvin. 1997. What moves where when in which language? Doctoral dissertation, MIT.

Riedel, Kristina. 2009. Object marking in *wh*-questions in Bantu. In *Selected proceedings of the 39th Annual Conference on African Linguistics*, ed. by Akinloye Ojo and Lioba Moshi, 67–76. Cascadilla Proceedings Project.

Rodríguez-Mondoñedo, Miguel. 2007. The syntax of objects: Agree and differential object marking. Doctoral dissertation, University of Connecticut.

Rudin, Catherine. 1997. AgrO and Bulgarian pronominal clitics. In *Formal Approaches to Slavic Linguistics 5: The Indiana Meeting*, ed. by Martina Lindseth and Steven Franks, 224–252. Michigan Slavic Publications.

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025

Linguistic Inquiry Early Access Corrected Proof
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00545
© 2024 by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Sağ, Yağmur. 2019. The semantics of number marking: Reference to kinds, counting, and optional classifiers. Doctoral dissertation, Rutgers University.
Saito, Mamoru. 2007. Notes on East Asian argument ellipsis. *Language Research* 43:203–227.
Sakamoto, Yuta. 2020. *Silently structured silent argument.* John Benjamins.
Schneider-Zioga, Patricia. 1995. Specifier head agreement in Kinande. In *Cahiers linguistiques d'Ottawa*, 67–93. University of Ottawa, Department of Linguistics and Modern Languages.
Schneider-Zioga, Patricia. 2007. Anti-agreement, anti-locality and minimality: The syntax of dislocated subjects. *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory* 25:403–446.
Şener, Serkan. 2008. Non-canonical case licensing is canonical: Accusative subjects of CPs in Turkish. Ms., University of Connecticut.
Şener, Serkan. 2010. (Non-) peripheral matters in Turkish syntax. Doctoral dissertation, University of Connecticut.
Şener, Serkan, and Daiko Takahashi. 2010. Ellipsis of arguments in Japanese and Turkish. *Nanzan Linguistics* 6:79–99.
Sugar, Alexander. 2019. Verb-linking and events in syntax: The case of Uyghur-*(i)p* constructions. Doctoral dissertation, University of Washington.
Taguchi, Shigeki. 2015. Syntactic operations on heads and their theoretical implications. Doctoral dissertation, University of Connecticut.
Tanaka, Hidekazu. 2002. Raising to object out of CP. *Linguistic Inquiry* 33:637–652.
Todorovic, Neda. 2016. On the presence/absence of TP: Syntactic properties and temporal interpretation. Doctoral dissertation, University of Connecticut.
Tömür, Hämit. 2003. *Modern Uyghur grammar: Morphology.* Yıldız.
Torrego, Esther. 1998. *The dependencies of objects.* MIT Press.
Travis, Lisa deMena. 2010. *Inner aspect: The articulation of VP.* Springer.
Villa-García, Julio. 2015. *The syntax of multiple*-que *sentences in Spanish: Along the left periphery.* John Benjamins.
Wiltschko, Martina, and Elizabeth Ritter. 2015. Animating the narrow syntax. *The Linguistic Review* 32: 869–908.
Woolford, Ellen. 1999. Animacy hierarchy effects on object agreement. In *New dimensions in African linguistics and languages*, ed. by Paul Kotey, 205–215. Africa World Press.
Woolford, Ellen. 2001. Conditions on object agreement in Ruwund (Bantu). In *The UMOP volume on indigenous languages*, ed. by Elena Benedicto, 177–201. University of Massachusetts Amherst, Graduate Linguistics Students Association.
Wurmbrand, Susi. 2013. QR and selection: Covert evidence for phasehood. In *NELS 42: Proceedings of the 42nd Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society*, ed. by Stefan Keine and Shayne Sloggett, 2: 277–290. University of Massachusetts Amherst, Graduate Linguistics Students Association.
Yoo, Yong Suk. 2018. Mobility in syntax: On contextuality in labeling and phases. Doctoral dissertation, University of Connecticut.
Zanon, Ksenia. 2014. On the status of TP in Turkish. *Studies in Polish Linguistics* 9:163–201.
Zeller, Jochen. 2014. Three types of object marking in Bantu. *Linguistische Berichte* 239:347–367.
Zidani-Eroğlu, Leyla. 1997a. Exceptionally case-marked NPs as matrix objects. *Linguistic Inquiry* 28: 219–230.
Zidani-Eroğlu, Leyla. 1997b. Indefinite noun phrases in Turkish. Doctoral dissertation, The University of Wisconsin-Madison.

Robin Jenkins
Department of Linguistics
University of Connecticut, Storrs

robin.jenkins@uconn.edu

Downloaded from http://direct.mit.edu/ling/article-pdf/doi/10.1162/ling_a_00545/2477638/ling_a_00545.pdf by Kyushu University user on 09 May 2025